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milky mist®



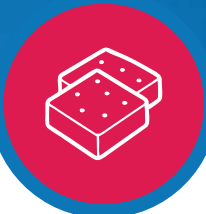
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*(Among companies with revenue scale of more than ₹15,000 million) in India in terms of revenue, growing at a CAGR of 31.26% from Fiscal 2024 to Fiscal 2026. (Source: 1Lattice Report) | # As of March 31, 2026

MILKY MIST DAIRY FOOD LIMITED is proposing, subject to applicable statutory and regulatory requirements, receipt of requisite approvals, market conditions and other considerations, to make an initial public offering of its Equity Shares and has filed the RHP with RoC, SEBI and the Stock Exchanges on August 4, 2026. The RHP is available on the website of SEBI at www.sebi.gov.in, and is available on the websites of the Stock Exchanges i.e. BSE and NSE at www.bseindia.com and www.nseindia.com, respectively, on the website of the Company at www.milkmyst.com and the websites of the BRLMs, i.e., JM Financial Limited, Axis Capital Limited and the Depository known as IFSC Securities Limited at www.ifscsecurities.com and www.secdatabase.com, respectively. Any potential investor should note that investment in equity shares involves a high degree of risk and for details relating to such risk, see “Risk Factors” beginning on page 23 of the RHP. Potential investors should not rely on the DRHP and should instead rely on their own examination of the Offer, including the risks involved, for making any investment decision. The Equity Shares offered in the Offer have not been and will not be registered under the U.S. Securities Act of 1933, as amended (the “U.S. Securities Act”) or any state securities laws in the United States and, unless so registered, may not be offered or sold within the United States, except pursuant to an exemption from, or in a transaction not subject to, the registration requirements of the U.S. Securities Act and applicable state securities laws. Accordingly, such Equity Shares are being offered and sold (i) outside of the United States in offshore transactions in reliance on Regulation S under the U.S. Securities Act and the applicable laws of the jurisdiction where those offers and sales occur; and (ii) within the United States to “qualified institutional buyers” (as defined in Rule 144A under the U.S. Securities Act), pursuant to the private placement exemption set out in Section 4(a) of the U.S. Securities Act. The Equity Shares have not been and will not be registered, listed or otherwise qualified in any other jurisdiction outside India and may not be offered or sold, and Bids may not be made by persons in any such jurisdiction, except in compliance with the applicable laws of such jurisdiction. There will be no public offering in the United States.

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MILKY MIST DAIRY FOOD LIMITED



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Brand*



Largest Private
Packaged
Cheese
Brand**



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Top Two Largest
Private Packaged
Yogurt
Brands#



*In the organized market with a market share of approximately 19% In terms of the organised packaged paneer market value in Fiscal 2026 in India (Source: 1Lattice Report) | **In South India in Fiscal 2026, with a market share of approximately 12% In terms of market value in the Southern region's organised cheese segment (Source: 1Lattice Report) | #With a market share of approximately 13% in terms of market value in the organized yogurt market in India (Source: 1Lattice Report)

MILKY MIST DAIRY FOOD LIMITED is proposing, subject to applicable statutory and regulatory requirements, receipt of requisite approvals, market conditions and other considerations, to make an initial public offering of its Equity Shares and has filed the RHP with RoC, SEBI and the Stock Exchanges on August 4, 2026. The RHP shall be available on the website of SEBI at www.sebi.gov.in, and is available on the websites of the Stock Exchanges i.e. BSE and NSE at www.bseindia.com and www.nseindia.com, respectively, on the website of the Company at www.milkymist.com and the websites of the BRLMs, i.e., JM Financial Limited, Axis Capital Limited and IIFL Capital Services Limited (formerly known as IIFL Securities Limited) at www.jmfl.com, <https://www.axiscapital.co.in/> and www.iiflcapital.com, respectively. Any potential investors should note that investment in equity shares involves a high degree of risk and for details relating to such risk, see "Risk Factors" beginning on page 23 of the RHP. Potential investors should not rely on the DRHP and should instead rely on their own examination of our Company and the Offer, including the risks involved, for making any investment decision. The Equity Shares offered in the Offer have not been and will not be registered under the U.S. Securities Act of 1933, as amended (the "U.S. Securities Act") or any state securities laws in the United States and, unless so registered, may not be offered or sold within the United States, except pursuant to an exemption from, or in a transaction not subject to, the registration requirements of the U.S. Securities Act and applicable state securities laws. Accordingly, such Equity Shares are being offered and sold (i) outside of the United States in offshore transactions in reliance on Regulation S under the U.S. Securities Act and the applicable laws of the jurisdiction where those offers and sales occur; and (ii) within the United States to "qualified institutional buyers" (as defined in Rule 144A under the U.S. Securities Act), pursuant to the private placement exemption set out in Section 4(a) of the U.S. Securities Act. The Equity Shares have not been and will not be registered, listed or otherwise qualified in any other jurisdiction outside India and may not be offered or sold, and Bids may not be made by persons in any such jurisdiction, except in compliance with the applicable laws of such jurisdiction. There will be no public offering in the United States.



NATIONAL SONG ROW

Kerala Minister hints at withdrawing directive

SOUTH » PAGE 7

DRONE BARRAGES

Seven killed as Russia, Ukraine trade strikes

WORLD » PAGE 14





SLOGANS RAISED

Mamata faces protest in West Bengal district

NEWS » PAGE 11

RAHUL GANDHI WRITES

Either culpable or incompetent

Students were brutally attacked by forces which report to one man

EDITORIAL » PAGE 8



MEMORABLE TRIUMPH

Ashmita Chaliha wins Korea Masters title

SPORT » PAGE 15

NEARBY



CM expected to move resolution on State song

CHENNAI
Chief Minister C. Joseph Vijay is expected to move a resolution in the Assembly on Monday, stating that the State song, *Tamil Thai Vazhthu*, be mandatorily sung before official events in Tamil Nadu. » PAGE 6

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EDUCATIONPLUS » PAGE 17

Netanyahu rejects Trump’s 15-point proposal for Gaza

Israeli military will not withdraw from Gaza unless Hamas is ‘genuinely disarmed’, says the Israeli PM amid pressure from right-wing base ahead of election; willing to ‘challenge’ Trump, he adds

Agence France-Presse
JERUSALEM

Israeli Prime Minister Benjamin Netanyahu on Sunday rejected a U.S.-led Gaza plan endorsed by Hamas, putting distance between himself and U.S. President Donald Trump as he tries to shore up his base ahead of close elections.

After more than a week of gradually escalating criticism of the plan proposed by the Board of Peace, and despite receiving assurances that Israel would not need to start withdrawing from Gaza immediately, Mr. Netanyahu explicitly opposed the deal following pushback from his right-wing allies.

“Israel rejects the 15-point document,” Mr. Netanyahu said, referring to

Difference of opinions

The Israeli PM’s opposition to the proposal comes after more than a week of gradually escalating criticism of the plan

What the plan says:

■ Hamas would surrender weapons to a nascent Palestinian governing body

■ Israel would begin pulling out forces in tandem with the disarmament



They [U.S.] have ideas; some of them are acceptable to us and some are not, and we know how to stand our ground

BENJAMIN NETANYAHU
Israeli Prime Minister



the plan Hamas agreed to in late July.

The Israeli military “will not carry out any withdrawal until Hamas is genuinely disarmed, and will continue to thwart threats against our forces and our citizens”, he told a Cabinet meeting.

Mr. Netanyahu described Mr. Trump, who

had hailed the Gaza deal as a milestone for peace, as “our greatest friend in the White House”, but quickly made clear he was willing to challenge him, saying Israel was raising its objections with the United States.

“They have ideas; some of them are acceptable to us and some are not, and

we know how to stand our ground on these matters,” he said.

Mr. Netanyahu, Israel’s longest-serving leader, is running even or trailing in some polls ahead of October 27 elections, the country’s first since the devastating October 7, 2023 attack by Hamas that sparked the war on Gaza.

Polls show that the Gaza plan is unpopular with Mr. Netanyahu’s right-wing base, and far-right members of his Cabinet have urged him to kill it.

Hamas, days after selecting a new leader, Khalil al-Hayya, announced it supported the Gaza plan, and has since called on Washington to push Mr. Netanyahu to accept it.

Hamas in a statement said it was still committed to the plan.

Jharkhand govt. cancels 3 exams as protests continue

Suruchi Kumari
RANCHI

The Jharkhand government on Sunday agreed to cancel the 14th Jharkhand Public Service Commission (JPSC) preliminary examination and the JPSC backlog examinations held in 2023 and 2025 following discussions with protesting student groups.

The State’s Technical and Higher Education Minister, Sudivya Kumar, said the government had accepted “98% of the demands” of the protesting groups. The government also announced an Enforcement Directorate probe into alleged financial irregularities in the JPSC exam.

However, the students remained firm on their demand for a probe by the Central Bureau of Investigation into the alleged irregularities in the Jharkhand Staff Selection Commission-Combined Graduate Level (JSSC-CGL) examination and said the



A Jharkhand government delegation with student representatives at the State Guest House in Ranchi, after the meeting on Sunday. PTI

agitation would continue, including a march to the State Assembly on Monday. The announcement came even as all three JPSC members resigned and Chief Minister Hemant Soren assured protesters that “justice will be delivered with full transparency”.

‘No jurisdiction’

“The government has agreed with the demand for cancellation of the 14th JPSC and backlog examinations of 2023 and 2025,” Mr. Kumar said, adding that the State cannot recommend a CBI probe “as

we do not have jurisdiction over the JSSC-CGL exams that happened in line with High Court and Supreme Court directions”.

The protesting groups, led by Jharkhand Loktantrik Krantikari Morcha (JLKM) and JPSC-JSSC Reforms Manch, said they wanted cancellation of the JSSC-CGL and all exams connected to the TSR Data Processing Private Ltd., a blacklisted entity.

CONTINUED ON

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‘WILL SAFEGUARD FUTURE’

» PAGE 10

Houthis hit Saudi oil facility, kill 11 in Yemen

Agence France-Presse
ADEN

At least 11 persons were killed in Houthi strikes in Yemen’s port city of Mokha on Sunday while a drone salvo by the Iran-aligned rebels targeted a Saudi Arabian oil refinery on the Kingdom’s Red Sea coast.

The attack in Mokha comes after a years-long truce in the civil war between the Houthis and the Saudi Arabia-backed, internationally recognised Yemeni government appeared to collapse as fighting between the rebels and the Kingdom in West Asia flared in recent weeks.

A medical source in Mokha said three civilians and eight military personnel had been killed in the

Houthi attack. Mokha is one of the main ports under Yemen’s internationally recognised government and has been renovated to handle shipping that avoids the Houthi-held port of Hodeida.

Two sources with the government forces earlier confirmed at least eight troops had been killed and more than 40 personnel were injured, saying that the Houthis attacked Mokha with several waves of missile and drones.

The Houthis’ military spokesperson Yahya Saree said the group targeted “Saudi enemy” troops and equipment in the area with missiles and drones.

CONTINUED ON

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Almond season



Valley of plenty: Farmers collect almonds during the harvesting season at a village in Pulwama district of Jammu and Kashmir on Sunday. Almond cultivation is a key agricultural activity in the Kashmir Valley, contributing to the livelihoods of thousands of families. IMRAN NISSAR

J&K group flags ‘terror threat’ against Pandits

The Hindu Bureau
SRINAGAR

A Kashmir organisation on Sunday expressed concerns over purported online threats issued by terrorists to Pandits living in the Valley and demanded a probe, saying that the threats had “forced many minority community employees” working in the region to “go on leave”.

The Panun Kashmir, a Jammu-based organisation of Kashmiri Pandits, said the purported threat communication, dated August 7 and issued in the name of the United Liberation Council, “has specifically named members of the Kashmiri Pandit community and disclosed their telephone numbers”.

Scores of Pandits working in Kashmir have left the Valley after the fresh threat, sources say

Official sources said scores of Pandits working in Kashmir under the Prime Minister’s rehabilitation package had left the Valley in the face of the fresh threat. They said departments in “volatile and sensitive locations” in Kashmir had allowed Pandit employees to go on leave till August 20. However, there has been no official communication from the government.

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Velumani, Viswanathan blame EPS for setbacks to AIADMK

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

Mounting pressure on AIADMK general secretary Edappadi K. Palaniswami, senior party leaders and former Ministers S.P. Velumani and Natham R. Viswanathan have opposed the removal of “more than 400 members” of the party general council and executive committee.

They have also called for re-induction of the party’s former interim general secretary, V.K. Sasikala, and the former deputy general secretary, T.T.V. Dhinakaran, into the AIADMK.

Among other charges, the two leaders said Mr. Palaniswami “did not use the



S.P. Velumani

opportunity to have an alliance with the TVK”.

An undated, four-page letter lays bare the internal affairs of the party since the 2021 Assembly election, lists the instances of possible alliances, including those with the BJP and the TVK, having failed to

materialise, and pinned the blame on Mr. Palaniswami’s leadership and handling of the party matters.

The letter, meant for the “notice of the party general secretary”, was signed by Mr. Velumani and Mr. Viswanathan.

“You have so far removed over 400 members of the party’s general council and executive committee so that none should express any view contrary to yours,” said the letter, which surfaced days after Mr. Velumani and others called on TVK general secretary and Minister N. Anand.

CONTINUED ON

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Ladakh to lead Independent India’s first caste census

Vijaita Singh
NEW DELHI

Ladakh, one of the two youngest Union Territories in the country, is set to lead the way in demonstrating how caste will be enumerated for the first time in Independent India. The second phase of the Census – the Population Enumeration (PE) – which starts on August 17 in Ladakh and other snow-bound areas, is likely to ask questions on 40 parameters and provide an open-ended column for caste enumeration.

While the ongoing exercise is India’s first digital Census, officials are making an exception for Ladakh by printing a sufficient number of paper schedules. The move takes into account the presence of large defence establish-



Enumerators interact with residents during an awareness campaign in Birbhum, West Bengal, as part of the Census 2027. PTI

ments in the region bordering China and Pakistan, whose locations cannot be geo-tagged because of security concerns. The digital Census mandatorily requires enumerators to geo-locate the structures on a mobile App. Respondents who self-enumerate on Census portal are also required to do the same.

As reported by *The Hin-*

du on July 6, the rehearsal, or the “pre-test”, for the PE phase was conducted from July 1 to 20 in 16 States and Union Territories, where respondents, other than those from Scheduled Castes and Scheduled Tribes, recorded their castes in an “open column”, or the enumerator noted a resident’s caste as declared by them. The

methodology is likely to be retained in the final form.

Ladakh’s case is peculiar as it was not among these 16 States and Union Territories.

Though the questionnaire or the schedule is yet to be notified by the Registrar General and Census Commissioner of India (RG&CCI), preparations have begun in Ladakh and snow-bound areas of Jammu and Kashmir, Himachal Pradesh, and Uttarakhand to conduct PE from August 17 to September 30, ahead of the rest of the country, where the exercise will be conducted in February 2027. The Directorate of Census Operations, Jammu & Kashmir and Ladakh, has concluded a three-day Master Trainers’ Training Programme for Census 2027 population enumera-

tion, marking the next phase of field preparedness.

According to Chief Principal Census Officer, Amit Sharma, the three-day programme provided comprehensive training on all aspects of Census 2027 population enumeration, covering census concepts, caste and demographic data collection, digital tools, self-enumeration, interviewing techniques, and hands-on use of the mobile application.

A senior government official said that, in the absence of the pre-test in Ladakh, the master-trainers are being trained based on tentative questions, around 40, which are likely to be notified this week.

CONTINUED ON

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INBRIEF



Singappenn marathon held for awareness on cervical cancer

Singappen Special Force chief K. Bhavaneeswari flagged-off the Singappen marathon at Marina Beach on Sunday for creating awareness of cervical cancer and the women's safety helpline. The marathon was held from Island Grounds to Light House. It was organised by the Rotary Club of Madras Central, InnerWheel Clubs of District 323 and the Singappen Special Force, and saw the participation of more than 3,000 people. Ms. Bhavaneeswari stressed the need to strengthen women's safety through the national women helpline no. 1091. Sridhar Krishnaswamy, president of the Rotary Club of Madras Central, also participated.

Movie screening organised for Thalassemia warriors

Apollo Speciality Hospitals, Teynampet, organised a special screening of *Spider-Man: Brand New Day* at Kamala Cinemas for around 100 young "Thalassemia warriors" and their families and caregivers. A release from the hospital said, the choice of the movie was fitting as its story reflects courage, hope and the strength to overcome challenges. Revathi Raj, Senior Consultant - Paediatrics & Haematology Oncology, Apollo Speciality Hospitals, Teynampet, said: "We wanted to give them a moment to forget the hospital, laugh freely and simply be children." Ramya U., Consultant - Paediatric Haematology, Apollo Speciality Hospitals, Teynampet, said: "Our Thalassemia Warriors show remarkable courage, and today is about celebrating their childhood, dreams and happiness."

Doctor held for misbehaving with nurse at hospital

The MKB Nagar All Women Police arrested a 34-year-old doctor for misbehaving with a 20-year-old nurse at a private hospital in Manali Salai, Kodungaiyur, on Saturday. On Friday evening, when the nurse was attending to a patient, Syed Masth Ahamed, who was on duty, tried to misbehave with her. On a complaint from the nurse, the police filed a case and arrested the doctor under three Sections of the Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita and one section of the Tamil Nadu Prohibition of Harassment of Women Act. He was then produced before a judicial magistrate and sent to prison.

Text & Context and Science

Weekday features on *The Hindu* epaper (epaper.thehindu.com) carries explainers, special articles and quizzes. In the latest issue (August 10, Monday), the following explainers are available:

- The stakes in India's delimitation debate newsth.live/delimitationdebate
 - If DNA is the instruction manual, we just opened a big second volume newsth.live/genresearch
- You can use your smartphone's inbuilt features to access this article. If it's an Android phone, use Google Lens to read and tap the url to access the article. If it's an iPhone, use Live Text on camera to do the same.

Your feedback will keep us Cleaner, Sharper and Bolder

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THE HINDU thehindu.businessline.com

FRONTLINE SPORTSTAR thehindu.youthworld.com THE HINDU

National Highways Authority of India
(Ministry of Road Transport & Highways)

भर्ती सूचना /RECRUITMENT NOTICE

भारतीय राष्ट्रीय राजमार्ग प्राधिकरण (भा.रा.रा.प्र.) सचिवालय पर निम्नलिखित पद पर नियुक्ति हेतु आवेदन आमंत्रित करता है:-
National Highways Authority of India (NHAI) invites applications from professionals for engagement to following post on contract basis:-

Name of the post	No. of posts*
युवा पेशेवर (विधि) Young Professionals (Legal)	05

*पदों की संख्या भा.रा.रा.प्र. की आवश्यकता के अनुसार बढ़ाई या घटाई जा सकती है।
*Number of posts may increase/decrease as per requirement of NHAI.
2. पात्रता मानदंड और अन्य शर्तें भा.रा.रा.प्र. की वेबसाइट www.nhai.gov.in पर देखे जा सकते हैं।
Eligibility criteria and other conditions may be seen on NHAI's website www.nhai.gov.in

3. आवेदन जमा करना: इच्छुक और पात्र उम्मीदवार अपने आवेदन 08.09.2026 (सोमवार 06:00 बजे तक) भा.रा.रा.प्र. की वेबसाइट पर उपलब्ध लिंक के माध्यम से केवल ऑनलाइन जमा करें।
Submission of Applications: Applications are to be submitted online only. Eligible candidates may apply online on the link provided on the website of NHAI by 08.09.2026 (upto 06:00 PM).

4. इस विज्ञापन के संबंध में शुद्धिपत्र/अनुशेष/निरस्तोकरण, यदि कोई होगा तो, उसे केवल भा.रा.रा.प्र. की वेबसाइट पर प्रकाशित किया जाएगा।
Corrigendum/Addendum/Cancellation to this advertisement, if any, shall be published on NHAI website only.

BUILDING A NATION, NOT JUST ROADS

CMRL to deploy three more tunnel boring machines for Phase II Metro Rail works

The TBMs, to be procured at a cost of ₹180 crore, will be deployed on Thiruvanmiyur to Taramani, Thousand Lights to Anna Flyover, and Mandaiveli to Thirumayilai stretches to speed up tunneling

Sunitha Sekar
CHENNAI

Due to the delay in tunneling in various stretches of the Phase II network, Chennai Metro Rail will shortly procure three additional tunnel boring machines (TBM) to speed up works.

According to officials of Chennai Metro Rail Limited (CMRL), the TBM's will be deployed on three stretches – Thiruvanmiyur to Taramani, Thousand Lights to Anna Flyover, and Mandaiveli to Thirumayilai. CMRL will buy them at an estimated cost of ₹180 crore.

In the 118.9-km Phase II project, 23 TBMs are deployed at present. These three stretches fall under Corridor 3, which originates at Madhavaram and ends at SIPCOT with a total distance of 45.8 km. For this corridor, 43.04 km (upline and downline) has to be tunneled. So far,



On track: Officials said the tunneling work was progressing well despite delays, and work will pick up pace when the additional tunnel boring machines are deployed. FILE PHOTO

CMRL has completed only 19.68 km, and another 23.36 km of tunneling is pending.

This corridor has the maximum length of underground network at 26.7 km in the Phase II project.

"Based on the current pace of work, we need only three additional TBMs. If there is further need, we will purchase a fourth machine. These three TBMs

will reach the city in the coming months, one after the other," an official said.

The need to get more TBMs for the Phase II network was due to the inordinate delay in the tunneling operations.

Factors that significantly contributed to the delay in works include the cancellation of tenders floated for building underground stations, the delay in complet-

ing the construction of the station shaft, and the relocation of various types of utilities.

But officials said the work was progressing well, and tunneling work would pick up pace when the additional TBMs are deployed. A few TBMs, which were stuck underground due to the delay in station shaft construction, have made a breakthrough.

GCC officials told to expedite civic works, initiate pending projects



G.S. Sameeran

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

Greater Chennai Corporation (GCC) Commissioner G.S. Sameeran has directed officials to expedite ongoing civic works and initiate pending projects during a review meeting at the Ripon Buildings.

Assessing precautionary

measures for Northeast monsoon on Saturday, the Commissioner ordered the desilting of stormwater drains, improvement of canals, and the pruning of precarious tree branches.

As of July 15, GCC has constructed 1,016.25 kilometres (km) of stormwater drains against a target of 1,126 km, at an estimated

cost of ₹5,127.40 crore.

The civic body has removed 16,270 metric tonnes (MT) of silt and water hyacinth from major canals using amphibian vehicles and robotic excavators.

Further, 68,281 of the city's 1,09,975 silt catch pits have been cleaned. Officials were instructed

to maintain the readiness of high-capacity motor pumps, 215 relief centres, and community kitchens.

The review meeting also evaluated the progress of infrastructure initiatives at the detailed project report and tender stages, including urban primary health centres, modern bus shelters, gig workers' resting

facilities, integrated sports complexes, and the restoration of 49 ponds completed at an estimated ₹214.02 crore.

The Commissioner also issued directives to initiate strict action against unauthorised constructions and the commercial utilisation of residential buildings.

कार्यपालक अभियंता का कार्यालय
ग्रामीण विकास विशेष प्रमंडल, रॉंची

ई-निविदा आमंत्रण सूचना

ई- अल्पकालीन निविदा सूचना सं० – RDD/SD/RANCHI/02/2026-27 E-tender

1. कार्य की विस्तृत विवरणी :

क्र० सं०	कार्य का नाम	प्राक्कलित राशि (लाख में)	अग्रघन की राशि	परिमाण विपन्न का मूल्य	कार्य पूर्ण करने की अवधि
1	रॉंची जिला के नामकुम प्रखंड अंतर्गत पंचायत हुवांगहातू के डोकापीड़ी एवं डाउडीह के बीच कुडुन्दा इकीर नदी पर पुल निर्माण।	288.747	5,77,500	10,000	18 माह

2. वेबसाइट में निविदा प्रकाशन की तिथि – 12.08.2026

3. ई-निविदा प्राप्त की तिथि एवं समय – दिनांक 13.08.2026 से दिनांक 03.09.2026 को अपराह्न 5:00 बजे तक

4. ई-निविदा खोलने का स्थान – कार्यपालक अभियंता का कार्यालय, ग्रामीण विकास विशेष प्रमण्डल, रॉंची।

5. ई-निविदा खोलने की तिथि एवं समय – 05.09.2026 अपराह्न 2:00 बजे

6. ई-निविदा आमंत्रित करने वाले पदाधिकारी का नाम एवं पता :- कार्यपालक अभियंता, ग्रामीण विकास विशेष प्रमंडल, रॉंची।

7. ई-निविदा प्रकोष्ठ का दूरभाष सं० – 7903003903

8. परिमाण विपन्न की राशि घट-बढ़ सकती है तदनुसार अग्रघन की राशि देय होगी।

9. निविदा शुल्क एवं अग्रघन की राशि केवल Online Mode द्वारा स्वीकार्य होगी।

10. निविदा शुल्क एवं अग्रघन की राशि का ई-भुगतान जिस खाता से किया जायेगा, उसी खाते में अग्रघन की राशि वापस होगी। अगर खाता को बंद कर दिया जाता है, तो उसकी सारी जवाबदेही आपकी होगी।

विस्तृत जानकारी के लिये वेबसाईट www.jharkhandtenders.gov.in एवं कार्यालय की सूचना पट्ट पर देखा जा सकता है।

कार्यपालक अभियंता
ग्रामीण विकास विशेष प्रमंडल, रॉंची

PR 387028 Rural Development (26-27)_D

झारखण्ड सरकार
कार्यपालक अभियंता का कार्यालय
ग्रामीण विकास विशेष प्रमण्डल, हजारीबाग

ई- निविदा आमंत्रण सूचना

ई-निविदा सं० :- RDD/SD/HZB/19/2026-27

1. कार्य की विस्तृत विवरणी :

युप सं०	आईन्टेन्डिफिकेशन संख्या/ पैकेज संख्या	प्रखण्ड	योजना का नाम	प्राक्कलित राशि	अग्रघन की राशि	परिमाण विपन्न का मूल्य	कार्य पूर्ण करने की अवधि
1.	RDD/SD/HZB/19/01/2026-27	कटकमसांडी	हजारीबाग जिला अंतर्गत कटकमसांडी प्रखण्ड के पंचायत डोठवा बक्वा नदी पर पुल निर्माण।	2,60,07,000.00	5,20,140.00	10000.00	18 माह
2.	RDD/SD/HZB/19/02/2026-27	कटकमसांडी	हजारीबाग जिला अंतर्गत कटकमसांडी प्रखण्ड के ग्राम लखनु बतरा जिला के ग्राम -खलारी से जोड़ने वाले मछाने नदी में पुल निर्माण।	3,97,78,400.00	7,95,568.00	10000.00	18 माह

2. वेबसाइट में निविदा प्रकाशन की तिथि – 18.08.2026

3. ई-निविदा प्राप्त की तिथि एवं समय – दिनांक 18.08.2026 से दिनांक 07.09.2026 को अपराह्न 5:00 बजे तक

4. ई-निविदा खोलने का स्थान – कार्यपालक अभियंता का कार्यालय, ग्रामीण विकास विशेष प्रमण्डल, हजारीबाग

5. ई-निविदा खोलने की तिथि एवं समय –09.09.2026 अपराह्न 2:00 बजे

6. ई-निविदा आमंत्रित करने वाले पदाधिकारी का नाम एवं पता :- कार्यपालक अभियंता, ग्रामीण विकास विशेष प्रमंडल, हजारीबाग

7. ई-निविदा प्रकोष्ठ का दूरभाष सं० – 9934523795

8. परिमाण विपन्न की राशि घट-बढ़ सकती है तदनुसार अग्रघन की राशि देय होगी।

9. निविदा शुल्क एवं अग्रघन की राशि केवल Online Mode द्वारा स्वीकार्य होगी।

10. निविदा शुल्क एवं अग्रघन की राशि का ई-भुगतान जिस खाता से किया जायेगा, उसी खाते में अग्रघन की राशि वापस होगी।

विस्तृत जानकारी के लिये वेबसाईट www.jharkhandtenders.gov.in एवं कार्यालय की सूचना पट्ट पर देखा जा सकता है।

कार्यपालक अभियंता
ग्रामीण विकास विशेष प्रमंडल, हजारीबाग

PR 387042 Rural Development(26-27)#D

Public Notice
Jharkhand Renewable Energy Development Agency

Objections/ Comments invited from various stakeholders on the feed-in tariff petition for ground-mounted, Canal-top and Floating Solar Projects having Capacity less than 10 MW.

Jharkhand Renewable Energy Development Agency(JREDA) is a Nodal Agency for Renewable Energy Development in the State of Jharkhand. The Jharkhand Renewable Energy Development Agency (JREDA) has filed a petition for determining feed-in tariff for Ground Mounted, Canal-top and Floating Solar Projects having Capacity less than 10 MW.

1. The copy of the petition can be downloaded from the website of JREDA <https://jreda.com/Content/getHeadersMenuContents/187> and from the website of the Commission www.jserc.org/jreda.aspx.

2. Suggestions/comments may be sent to the below contact detail within 2 weeks of issuance of this notice:

The Secretary
Jharkhand State Electricity Regulatory Commission
1st Floor, Jharkhand State Housing Board (Old Head Quarter)
Harmu Housing Colony, Ranchi-834002, Jharkhand
Email Id-secretary@jserc.org

3. The objections can be submitted in English or in Hindi. The sender should clearly specify his/her full name, postal address, e-mail id and telephone number. It should also be indicated if the objection is being filed on behalf of any organisation, consumer or consumer group.

Sd/-
Name & Signature of the Authorised Representative

PR 387004 Energy(26-27).D

INBRIEF



Walkathon to raise awareness on vascular diseases held

The Chennai Vascular Society organised a walkathon at Elliot's Beach in Besant Nagar on Sunday to mark National Vascular Day and raise awareness on vascular diseases and limb health. Over 1,000 people, including vascular surgeons, doctors, students, and members of the public, participated. The campaign was held under the theme 'Save Limbs - To Save Life', with a focus on preventing avoidable amputations through early diagnosis and treatment. The event was attended by Justice C. Saravanan of the Madras High Court and A. Aravind, Dean, Stanley Medical College, and senior medical professionals. K. Elancheralathan, president of the Chennai Vascular Society and Head of the Department of Vascular Surgery at Government Stanley Hospital, stressed greater awareness of vascular diseases.

Graduates advised not to depend only on technology

K.M. Suceendran, head, Academic Alliances Group, Tata Consultancy Services, said continuous learning, responsible use of social media, networking and maintaining good health were important elements of a successful career. Addressing the convocation of St. Joseph College of Engineering in Chennai on Saturday, he called upon the graduates to remain curious, listen carefully, build meaningful relationships, mentor younger students and contribute positively to society. "Don't depend only on technology; develop your own actual intelligence. Read, stay updated, meet people and remain curious," he said. R. Parthasarathy, global head, Talent Acquisition, Wipro, also spoke. B. Babu Manoharan, chairman, St. Joseph Group of Institutions, presided over the function.

Institute releases textbooks for neurodivergent students

Meghna M.
CHENNAI

In an effort to standardise the curriculum for neurodivergent children, Chennai-based Prakramika Vocational Institute has brought out textbooks for them to ensure their education is not broken.

"A uniform curriculum per se for neurodivergent children does not exist. Special schools follow their own based on the broad needs of the child; however, the continuity in their education might be broken as they move around different schools," said founder and director of the institute Gayatri Narasimhan. She also pointed out that a structured curriculum provides a common academic framework which enables consistency in teaching and continuity in learning across special schools.

To bridge this, Ms. Gayatri came out with a curriculum and launched 'Beyond Labels' textbooks for the children. "The 23 textbooks cater to neurodivergent children from birth to 25 years," she said.



The books are designed for children with autism spectrum disorder, Down syndrome, and intellectual disability.

The curriculum covers topics including communication skills, mathematics, functional academics, computer skills, activities of daily living, financial literacy, sex education, safety, personality development, self-advocacy, soft skills, physical fitness, yoga, and vocational education. The books are designed for children with autism spectrum disorder, Down syndrome, and intellectual disability.

The books integrate academic learning with communication, functional independence, life skills, workplace

Timings
CHENNAI

Chennai Weather	max	min
Thiruvallur	37	25
Chennai Airport	36	24
Chennai City	36	25

Chennai Airport Today
35°C The weather will be warm and uneasy. Chances of light rain and thundershowers. Night also will be comfortable.

Chennai Airport Tomorrow
36°C Morning will be comfortable. Day will be warm. Spell of light rain and thundershowers to occur.

THE HINDU
DISCLAIMER: Readers are requested to verify and make appropriate enquiries to satisfy themselves about the veracity of an advertisement before responding to any published in this newspaper. THE PUBLISHING PVT LTD, the Publisher & Owner of this newspaper, does not vouch for the authenticity of any advertisement or advertiser or for any of the advertiser's products and/or services. In no event can the Owner, Publisher, Printer, Editor, Director/s, Employees of this newspaper/company be held responsible/liable in any manner whatsoever for any claims and/or damages for advertisements in this newspaper.

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Police cancel film event at mall in Velachery owing to stampede-like situation

Thousands of motorists were put to hardship due to traffic gridlock in and around Velachery, as huge crowds thronged Phoenix Mall for a film event; heavy rain worsened the traffic situation

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

On Saturday, thousands of motorists were put to hardship on several roads in and around Velachery for hours after people thronged a film event at a mall. A stampede-like situation arose in the mall as the surging crowds became uncontrollable. Alarmed, the city police cancelled the event, which was scheduled for the evening.

Usually on weekends, the Phoenix Mall junction would be crowded as hundreds throng the mall. On Saturday, Google Maps showed heavy traffic near the mall from afternoon as people, mostly youngsters, started arriving early for the film event that was to be held in the evening. The event was not ticketed. By early evening, it took more than an hour to cross the mall and reach Guindy. The locals had no idea about the unusual crowd surge, but they had to tolerate the inconvenience and move at a snail's pace.

On Sunday, the social media was abuzz with videos of the huge traffic jam outside the mall and the uncontrollable crowd that had gathered inside the



Massive hold-up: Google Maps showed heavy traffic near the mall from afternoon as people started arriving early for the film event that was to be held in the evening on Saturday. SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT

mall. The videos went viral on social media with netizens raising questions on why the city police granted permission for the event in a mall located on a narrow road.

S. Nagavel, a resident of Velachery, who works in Vadapalani, complained that for any event where 'Hiphop Tamizha' Aadhi was present, there would be huge crowds, and being a film release function, the police should have given permission to hold the event on an open ground. He said that it took more than an hour to reach his office in Vadapalani.

On X, many users like

Rajesh pointed out that the traffic snarl on Saturday was unreal and that big events need crowd limits, public transit plans, and advance traffic advisories. Several motorists faced the same situation in all the link roads as well. The heavy rain worsened the traffic situation.

The situation was brought under control after the city traffic police forced the organisers to cancel the event and by deputing more traffic personnel at important junctions of the Velachery Main Road to regulate the vehicle movement.

A senior police officer

said that since it was an indoor event, the organisers did not seek permission from the traffic police. However, after coming to know that there was a huge crowd and that the traffic situation was going out of control, additional traffic personnel were immediately deputed to regulate the traffic. Senior police officials contacted the chief guest and stopped him from coming to the event, he added.

On Sunday, the traffic police, along with patrol vehicles, cleared even the slightest of bottleneck on the Velachery Main Road at every junction.

Chennai, a land of opportunity and exposure, says Health Minister

Chennai has always been a land of opportunity. To me, it is everything. What I am today is because of this city. The exposure it gave me shaped my life and career

I completed my schooling in Salem and moved to Chennai in 1997 to pursue MBBS at Madras Medical College (MMC). I still vividly remember the bus journey from Salem to Chennai.

Studying at MMC sparked my interest in administration. During my final year as a house surgeon, I visited the Secretariat nearly 30 times to meet friends. Those visits strengthened my resolve to pursue a career in administration. Then, most buses terminated at Parry's Corner,



K.G. Arunraj

where the MMC hostel was located.

It was a bustling hub for people arriving from across Tamil Nadu.

Evenings at Marina Beach with friends, followed by second-show movies at Devi Theatre on Mount Road and late-night dinners, will remain etched in my memory forever.

(As told to N. Sai Charan)

Hindustan Petroleum Corporation Limited
(A Maharatna Company)

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HPCL
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PERSONAL

CHANGE OF NAME

CHANGE OF NAME & D.O.B:
I, SANTHI mother of No.15683258N, Rank: HAV, Name: G.KARTHIK residing at Village-Rajapalayam, Rajapalayam-Post, Teh-Tirupattur, District-Tirupattur State-Tamil Nadu, Pin-635653. In my son's army records, my name and date of birth was wrongly entered as SANTHI & 01-07-1951 instead of my correct name and date of birth as SHANTHI GUNASEKARN & 04-08-1971. Tirupattur, 17-07-2026 Santhi (Mother)

I, ANAND Suryanarayanan, permanent resident of 42A, AF1 Vijay Manor Apt. Ramasamy St. Hastinapuram, Chennai-600064, declare Anand S and Anand Suryanarayanan both refer to me.

LEGAL NOTICE

IN THE COURT OF THE SPECIAL JUDGE FOR COMMERCIAL DISPUTES AT VIJAYAWADA, ANDHRA PRADESH C.O.No. 22 of 2025

Between:
M/s. Structured India Private Limited, represented by its Director Amudha Tower, III Floor, 25, Valayakkara Street, Tiruvannamalai-606 801 Tamil Nadu ... Plaintiff

Versus

The Union Bank of India, represented by its Branch Manager, Medavakkam Branch, Chennai-600 100 Tamil Nadu ... Defendant No. 2

COURT NOTICE

Whereas the above Commercial Original Suit is pending on the file of the Commercial Court at Vijayawada, Andhra Pradesh and whereas the Honble Court has ordered substituted service by way of publication to Defendant No. 2, The Union Bank of India, represented by its Branch Manager, Medavakkam Branch, Chennai, is hereby called upon to appear before the Commercial Court at Vijayawada, Andhra Pradesh on 21-08-2026 at 10.30.a.m, either personally or through a duly authorized Advocate/Counsel, without any failure.

Take notice that, in default of such appearance, the suit shall be proceeded with and decided ex parte in accordance with law. By Order of the Commercial Court at Vijayawada, Andhra Pradesh

S.R.A. ROSEDAAR
Counsel for Plaintiff
Vijayawada A.P.

LOST & FOUND

PASSPORT MISSING on 06/08/2026 No : V9721339 Pranithan Satishh Kumar. If anyone Find Please Ct: 8939238936

PASSPORT MISSING on 06/08/2026 No: T0723471 Sai Dakshinath Satishh Kumar. If anyone find Please Ct: 8939238936

PASSPORT MISSING on 06/08/2026 No: T0719499. Satishh Kumar Ramu. If anyone find Please Ct : 8939238936

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PUBLIC NOTICE

It is informed to the Public that my client The Chennai Metropolitan Co-operative Housing Society Ltd, rep. by its Administrator is the absolute owner of Land comprised in Survey Nos. 7/10B(0.64Acre), 7/13(0.49Acre), 62/2(2.17Acre), 62/3A(1.40Acre), 62/3B(1.40Acre), situated at Vedral Village, Kancheepuram District and they have misplaced the original Documents like Settlement Deed reg. Doc.No.1301/1960 Dt. 11/02/1960 at SRO, Kancheepuram, Sale Deed reg. Doc.No.5445/1973 Dt. 14/11/1973 at SRO, Kancheepuram Joint II and Sale Deed reg. Doc.No.343/1979 Dt. 09/03/1979, Sale Deed reg. Doc.No. 895/1975 Dt. 04/06/1975, Sale Deed reg. Doc.No.1877/1995 Dt. 19/07/1995, Sale Deed reg. Doc.No.1740/2002 Dt. 10/06/2002, Sale Deed reg. Doc.No.3666/2020 Dt. 13/10/2020, General Power of Attorney reg. Doc.No.84/IV/2002 Dt. 10/06/2002, Sale Deed reg.Doc.No.1375/2003 Dt. 14/05/2003, Sale Deed reg. Doc.No.3667/2020 Dt. 13/10/2020 and Sale Deed reg. Doc.No.2816/2006 Dt. 12/07/2006 all registered at SRO, Kancheepuram Joint IV.

Any person/s is/are having knowledge or possession of aforesaid Original Documents shall inform or lodge their claim or charge/s if any, to undermentioned address within 15 DAYS from today, failing which it would be deemed and concluded that the Documents are not traceable/available as such and no further claim/possession or create an interest either over the said Documents or property by anyone and subsequent claim will not be entertained and the same will not be binding on my client.

Mr. V.Sivakumar, Advocate, # 117-118, Angappan Naicken Street, Chennai - 600001
Cell: 94441 01414 & 95001 36204 Email: sivavlw@gmail.com

CINEMA ♦ ARTS ♦ EVENTS

MUSIC DANCE DRAMA

The Music Academy Madras
36th SPIRIT OF YOUTH FESTIVAL OF MUSIC AND DANCE Today: At the Kasturi Srinivasan Hall, 6 p.m. to 7.15 p.m Vignesh Shankarnarayanan (Vocal), B. Bhargava (Violin), Sairam Kumar (Mridangam) - 7.30 p.m. to 9 p.m. - Bharatanatyam by Shrinaguri Venkatesh (Disciple of Divya Navar). Members of the Academy are specially invited. The festival sponsored by SUNDARAM FASTENERS LIMITED and dedicated to the memory of Smt. Ambujam Krishna.

Arulmigu Sri Kapaleeswarar Temple, Mylapore, Chennai
Today (10-08-2026) Monday 6:45 PM - PRADHOSHAM Special "NAMASANKERTHANAM" by Sri. V. Karthik Gnaneshwar Bhagavathar & Group. All are welcome.

Bharatiya Vidya Bhavan, East Mada Street, Mylapore, Chennai-4
In association with Sri Krishna Sweets is celebrating "Aadi Bakthi Vizha"
Today: 10th August: 6:00 pm: High Tea, 6:30 pm: Inauguration followed by Discourse by "Kalaimamani Sri Nagai Mukundan" on "Kandhan Karuna"
Tomorrow: 11th August : 6:30 pm: Villupattu by "Kalaimamani Smt. Bharathi Thirumagan & team" on "Aadi Katril Amman Ula". All are Welcome.

Powered by : Nalli

Naada Inbam, 24992672
Today Smt. Shankari Natarajan Tribute concert. 6.15 pm Dr. R. LakshmiPriya, R. Srikriti, Sananth Parameswaran, Karaikkal Jaikishan, Ragasudha Hall.

Rasika Ranjani Sabha Foundation, Ch-4
Today at 5 pm, Aditi B Prahlad - Vocal, Amogh Nadadur - Violin, Nandan Kashyap - Mridangam. 6.45 pm Baanupriya - Vocal, Krithik Koushik - Violin, Gomathishankar - Mridangam. Ph: 8610357987. Rasikas welcome.

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MUSIC DANCE DRAMA

DAKSHINAMNAYA SRI SHARADA PEETHAM, SRINGERI
Vande Guruparamparam
Young Vidwans of Music and Shastras Share the Stage Parayana and Collective Prayer for World Peace.

Parayanam @ 5.30 pm - 6.15 pm - Shiva Sahasranamam

Vidwan Ramakrishnan Murthy
Violin R.K. Shriramkumar

Vidwan Dr. K.S.Maheshwaran Nambutiri
Mridangam N.C.Bharadwaj

Date : 10/08/2026 Time : 6.30 - 8.30pm
NARADA GANA SABHA (MAIN HALL)
All are welcome

M CH-CHE



CH-CHE

From Page One

Velumani, Viswanathan blame EPS for setbacks

Even after the party started losing strength since the 2026 Assembly election, functionaries who were discharging their duties efficiently in Coimbatore, Tiruppur, The Nilgiris, Cuddalore, Kallakurichi, Tiruchi, Thanjavur, Tenkasi, Villupuram, Tirupattur, Dharmapuri, Namakkal, Karur, Pudukkottai, and Perambalur were being removed from their posts, they said. “This is not acceptable. It will only weaken the party.”

The functionaries who were divested of the party membership were part of the AIADMK since its inception in 1972 and instrumental in maintaining the party’s electoral prospects thus far, they stressed. “The actions of the general secretary, which overlook their contributions to the party and weaken the party, should not continue. In the interest of the party, those who were removed should be given back their original positions,” they said. Party functionaries were to be elected to local bodies, which was quite important, they said. “We need to strengthen the party for this.”

Amit Shah’s proposal ‘disregarded’

The AIADMK lost the prospects in 42 constituencies in the 2021 Assembly election only because Mr. Palaniswami “disregarded” the proposal made by BJP leader and Union Minister Amit Shah to forge an alliance with Mr. Dhinakaran, which was accepted by former Chief Minister O. Panneerselvam, they said. “You denied a seat to TTV [Mr. Dhinakaran]. You did not embrace the DMDK, the Puthiya Thamizhagam, and Mr. Sarath Kumar (who were with us from 2019) and let them go in the 2021 Assembly election.”

Even after the BJP’s national leadership attempted repeatedly to forge an alliance by promising that all our demands would be fulfilled, “you acted arbitrarily and without thoughtfulness”, which led to the DMK-Congress alliance securing all the 40 seats [in the last Lok Sabha election], they said.

Krishnamurthy defends Palaniswami

AIADMK whip Agri S.S. Krishnamurthy said Mr. Palaniswami was not responsible for the poor performance of the party in the 2026 election as candidates were shortlisted by the district secretaries. Addressing journalists in Tiruvannamalai, Mr. Krishnamurthy said, “The AIADMK district secretaries act as “feudal lords” in their regions. The leadership merely announced the candidates recommended by the respective district secretaries. Who has to take responsibility for the party’s poor performance? Those district secretaries should take moral responsibility and resign,” he said.

How can there be a fair delimitation when it is a fraud: TNCC president

B. Manickam Tagore criticises DMK and AIADMK for ‘changing their view on the delimitation Bill in just a matter of months’, and not participating in the meeting convened by Chief Minister Vijay

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

Tamil Nadu Congress Committee (TNCC) president B. Manickam Tagore on Sunday said there could be no “fair delimitation”, and criticised certain political parties “for changing their tune in their opposition to the delimitation Bill in just a matter of months”.

Speaking at the anti-delimitation march held at Medavakkam in Chennai, Mr. Tagore said, “When Mahatma Gandhi, Jawaharlal Nehru, Kamarajar, and Vallabhbhai Patel called for the Quit India Movement on August 8, 1942, two groups did not take part in it: one, *sanghis*, and the other, everyone knows who they are.”

He further said those who did not participate in the meeting of MPs from Tamil Nadu were now “talking about fair delimitation”. The DMK, AIADMK, and their allies had stayed away from the delimitation discussion meeting chaired by Chief Minister C. Joseph Vijay on Saturday.

“This is a fraud – how can there be a fair and an unfair delimitation when it is a fraud? The [Prime Minister Narendra] Modi government is denying Tamil Nadu its financial share and schemes. We have 39



Strong opposition: TNCC president B. Manickam Tagore and Congress Rajya Sabha member Praveen Chakravarthy at a march to oppose the delimitation Bill, in Chennai on Sunday. SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT

MPs from Tamil Nadu. In April this year, we defeated the Bill [on delimitation] by voting against it. But those who said ‘no to delimitation’ are now calling for a ‘fair delimitation’. What is fair delimitation? They may increase the seats of Tamil Nadu and Uttar Pradesh by 50%. But, the 40 seats will become 60, and 80 will become 120. The difference in the number of seats between Tamil Nadu and Uttar Pradesh will be 60 after the delimitation. ‘Fair’ delimitation is a scam,” he said.

Congress Rajya Sabha member Praveen Chakravarthy said, “Tamil Nadu’s rights and freedom are in danger. The delimitation Bill will suppress its voice in Parliament. The share of MPs from Tamil Nadu and

Uttar Pradesh should remain the same. That’s our demand. But the BJP is trying to increase the representation of north Indian States. They are trying to defraud us by showing some numbers... if they increase our seats by 20, they will increase Uttar Pradesh’s by 40. We have to oppose this. All parties in Tamil Nadu should oppose the Bill... if they don’t, it is a betrayal.”

On the Mekedatu dam issue, Mr. Tagore said, “The Tamil Nadu Congress is very clear that the Meke-datu dam should not be allowed to be constructed. Who can give clearance? Only Prime Minister Modi, Chief Minister Vijay, and [Karnataka] Chief Minister D.K. Shivakumar can. Just like how we are fighting for

Tamil Nadu’s interests, the Chief Minister of Karnataka will fight for Karnataka’s interests.”

TNCC district president Vijay Sekar said the party’s district office-bearers held marches against delimitation across Chennai.

Viduthalai Chiruthaigal Katchi general secretary D. Ravikumar said any delimitation Bill, including the proposal that there would be a uniform increase of 50% for each State, would render the idea of parliamentary democracy in India “meaningless”.

Speaking to *The Hindu*, he said, “It is obvious that the BJP finds a great advantage in bringing in this delimitation at this moment. They could simply pass the Bills and amendments without any debate.”



Forest Department staff use a drone on Sunday to look for the carnivore that killed a man in the Nilgiris. SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT

58-year-old man dies in suspected tiger attack in Gudalur

The Hindu Bureau
UDHAGAMANDALAM

A 58-year-old man is believed to have been killed and eaten by a carnivore, most likely a tiger, in the O’Valley Forest Range at Gudalur in the Nilgiris on Saturday night.

Following the discovery of his remains on Sunday, local residents staged a protest and refused to allow the Forest Department to retrieve them for a post-mortem.

The deceased was identified as M. Balakrishnan, who was living near Manjushree Estate in O’Valley. According to the Forest Department, Balakrishnan was reported missing after he left for work on his farm on Saturday evening.

After receiving word about his disappearance, Forest Department workers launched a search in the area.

Protest staged

On Sunday, Balakrishnan’s remains were found in a field nearby, with most of the body consumed by a wild animal. The residents

staged a protest on Sunday morning, demanding that the animal involved in the attack be captured.

After lengthy discussions and assurances of action, the remains were taken for autopsy. The Forest Department said it had handed over interim compensation to his family and would expedite the release of the full compensation.

The department also said it had increased the presence of Rapid Response Team personnel, placed camera traps, and deployed drones to identify the animal involved in the attack. Officials said they could ascertain whether the attack was accidental or not only after identifying the carnivore.

Negative interactions

Conservationists said that in the last few years, negative interactions between humans and wildlife, especially elephants, had become acute in O’Valley.

The region is home to repatriated tea estate workers as well as more recent settlers who are vying with wildlife for space.

CM expected to move resolution prioritising Tamil Thai Vazhthu

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

Tamil Nadu Chief Minister C. Joseph Vijay is expected to move a resolution in the Assembly on Monday, mandating that the State Song, *Tamil Thai Vazhthu* (invocation to mother Tamil), be sung before the commencement of programmes held by all educational institutions, universities, government offices, public sector undertakings, and other public institutions in the State.

The move comes against the backdrop of a letter from the Union Ministry of Home Affairs on July 9, ask-

ing the States and Union Ministries to “strictly comply” with its January 28 directive that the National Song, *Vande Mataram*, be played before the National Anthem at official events.

In Tamil Nadu, a Government Order was issued on November 23, 1970, stipulating that *Tamil Thai Vazhthu* be sung at the commencement of official events.

On December 12, 2021, the State government officially recognised *Tamil Thaaai Vazhthu* as the State Song, and ordered that it be rendered first at all official events.

‘Absence of DMK, AIADMK MPs at meet regrettable’

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

Veteran Congress leader P. Chidambaram on Sunday said it was regrettable that MPs from the DMK, the AIADMK, the PMK, and the DMDK failed to attend the all-party meeting convened by the State government to discuss delimitation on Saturday.

“We lost the opportunity to convey to the world that there was a consensus among the political parties in Tamil Nadu. People should ask why the unity forged during the polls in April last year has frittered away now,” he said.

T.N. police arrest 837 cyber criminals in two days

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

In a crackdown on cyber-crime network, the Cyber Crime Wing (CCW) of the Tamil Nadu Police launched a 48-hour “State-wide Special Drive against Mule Account Holders” commencing on August 6, and arrested 837 cyber criminals across the State.

The operation focused on identifying persons involved in opening, operating, and facilitating the misuse of bank accounts for receiving and withdrawing proceeds from cyber fraud.

Acting on the instructions of the Director-General of Police and Head of the Police Force, Mahesh Kumar Aggarwal, special teams of the CCW conduct-



Investigators targeted individuals linked to 9,804 complaints about fraudulent transactions amounting to over ₹545 crore. GETTY IMAGES

ed the operation in all the districts and cities.

It was based on accused profiling through the National Cybercrime Reporting Portal and the Prati-bimb portal of the Indian Cybercrime Coordination Centre (I4C), Ministry of Home Affairs.

The profiling was further strengthened through

bank fund-trail linkages established by financial data analysis of cybercrime networks.

“Mule accounts are bank accounts used by cyber criminals to receive, transfer, layer, or withdraw money obtained through fraudulent and illegal activities. Individuals who allow their bank accounts to be

used for such transactions facilitate the movement of illicit funds,” Dr. Aggarwal said.

Investigators targeted individuals linked to 9,804 complaints involving fraudulent transactions amounting to more than ₹545 crore, and arrested 837 cyber criminals involved in 601 cases. Also, 157 new FIRs were registered across the State to curb the operation of mule bank accounts for facilitating cyber fraud.

The police said 204 mobile phones and other storage devices, some cash, and bank documents were seized from the premises of the accused.

Dr. Aggarwal said the arrests marked a significant achievement in disrupting and dismantling the organ-

ised cybercrime network operating in Tamil Nadu.

The operation was directly supervised from the police headquarters by the Additional Director-General of Police, CCW, Bala Naga Devi, to ensure seamless coordination and real-time monitoring throughout the drive.

The police were analysing the digital evidence seized and interrogating the arrested persons to uncover layers of the criminal network and identify their associates operating in other States. Efforts were on to trace and apprehend other members of the network, recover defrauded funds, and establish wider linkages with nationwide cybercrime operations, the police said in a statement.

Fifteen new judges of Madras High Court sworn in

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

The Madras High Court Chief Justice Sushrut Arvind Dharmadhikari on Sunday administered the oath of office to 15 new judges. With this, the working strength of the High Court has increased to 66, against its sanctioned strength of 75 judges.

Advocate-General (A-G) Vijay Narayan welcomed the new judges and introduced them. While the first five out of the eight elevated from the Bar had been appointed directly as permanent judges of the High Court, the rest had been appointed as additional judges for a fixed tenure.

Justice K. Govindarajan was born in Kulithalai, Karur district, in March 1972, and had been practicing as a lawyer since 1994. He was



Madras High Court Chief Justice Sushrut Arvind Dharmadhikari handing over the presidential warrant of appointment to Justice N. Ramesh after administering the oath of office to him on Sunday.

the founding member and convener of the Madurai Bench of the Madras High Court Bar Association, and served as the Deputy Solicitor General before his elevation.

Justice Rajnish Pathiyil was born in New Delhi to Indian Army veteran V. Muraleedharan in February 1973, and had pursued Masters in Law at the Un-

iversity of California. He had been practicing as a lawyer since 1997, and served as Special Public Prosecutor for the Directorate of Enforcement (ED) before his elevation.

Justice N. Ramesh, a first-generation lawyer, was born in 1973 and did his schooling in Vellore. He enrolled with the Bar Council of Tamil Nadu and

Puducherry in 1997, and was appointed as civil judge in December 2003. He resigned from Tamil Nadu State Judicial Service in March 2009 to return to practice. He was the Special Public Prosecutor for the ED till his elevation.

Justice G.K. Muthukumar enrolled as an advocate in 1998 and specialised in intellectual property law. He had served as Special Government Pleader. He was instrumental in obtaining geographical indication for several renowned products.

Justice R. Rajesh Vivekananthan, born in Thoothukudi in 1975, studied at the Madurai Government Law College. He had been practising since 1998, and had served as Deputy Solicitor General.

“It is a matter of pride

for all of us that this High Court has 13 women judges, the highest among all high courts in the country... Before concluding, on behalf of the Bar, I would like to make a small request to the honourable Chief Justice. When I joined the bar, the sanctioned strength of the High Court was only 18 judges... Today the strength is 75. Even when the sanctioned strength was 18, we never achieved a full strength... Even after the present appointments, there are still a few vacancies and I would like to express a hope that the remaining vacancies are also filled up at the earliest, so that one day, at least in my lifetime, we can see the full strength of 75 judges on this dais,” the A-G said.

Read the full story on newsth.live/newjudges

‘HR&CE Department keen on retrieving temple properties’

The Hindu Bureau
TIRUCHI

Minister for Hindu Religious and Charitable Endowments (HR&CE) S. Ramesh said on Sunday that the department was keen on retrieving temple properties and ensuring that properties belonging to temple trusts were used for the purposes for which they had been allocated.

Citing a recent instance, Mr. Ramesh said a First Information Report had been registered by the police against 19 persons based on a complaint by the HR&CE Department regarding the illegal registration of properties belonging to a trust established to serve the Madurai Mee-nakshi Amman Temple.



S. Ramesh

Some of the accused had been arrested in connection with the case, he said, adding that no action was taken during the previous DMK regime.

Speaking to journalists at Srirangam in Tiruchi, the Minister said that the ‘tirupani’ (renovation work) being taken up in various temples across the

State was being expedited.

During the ongoing Budget session, announcements would be made regarding the number of consecration ceremonies (‘kumbhabhishekam’) to be performed in temples; new ‘tirupani’ to be taken up; temples in fully/partially dilapidated state and their renovation; and the number of temple cars and temple tanks to be renovated, Mr. Ramesh added.

Mobile phone ban

Dedicated counters for depositing mobile phones would be established in major temples across the State before September 1. This was to prohibit the use of mobile phones on temple premises, the Minister said.

INBRIEF



Telangana launches portal for families of police ‘martyrs’

Recalling the sacrifice of 28 police personnel from erstwhile Warangal district who laid down their lives fighting naxalism, Telangana Director-General of Police C.V. Anand said that peace in the region was built on the sacrifices of personnel who placed duty above their lives. Mr. Anand launched TG-VEER, a dedicated portal for the families of police martyrs to register grievances relating to financial assistance, compassionate appointments and other benefits.

Auto driver, friend ‘sexually assault’ two children in A.P.

Two 13-year-old girls studying at a State-run institute and staying in its hostel were allegedly sexually assaulted by an autorickshaw driver and his friend in Krishna district of Andhra Pradesh. The girls had left school two days ago and boarded an autorickshaw at Machilipatnam later that night. The police booked the accused under the Protection of Children from Sexual Offences (POCSO) Act, 2012, and other relevant provisions, including rape, on Saturday.

Protest held in A.P. against seafarer deaths in war zones

The Merchant Navy Officers Welfare Association, Visakhapatnam, conducted a silent protest from the Kali Mata temple to the Beach Road in Andhra Pradesh on Sunday, condemning the killing of seafarers in war zones. Around 40 merchant navy seafarers took part in the protest and expressed solidarity with seafarers who lost their lives. The association sought compensation and adequate support for the kin of deceased seafarers from shipowners and agencies.

‘Mastermind’ in illegal explosives case arrested

The Hindu Bureau
MALAPPURAM

The National Investigation Agency (NIA) has reportedly arrested T.A. Harris, the alleged mastermind in a case involving the seizure of a huge cache of explosives from Chemmad, near Tirurangadi, in the Malappuram district of Kerala. He was reportedly arrested from Manjeri in the district.

According to the NIA, Mr. Harris played a key role in illegally procuring, stockpiling and distributing the explosives.

The seizure

The case relates to the seizure of 89,600 gelatin sticks and 10,500 non-electric detonators from a hollow bricks factory compound at Chemmad on February 7, 2026. They were stored in boxes and found hidden among onion sacks.

The case was handed over to the NIA after the explosives were found to have been brought without a licence. The NIA took over the investigation citing its national security implications.

19 locations searched

The NIA conducted searches at around 19 locations across Kerala, Tamil Nadu and Karnataka, recovering digital devices and documents.

Three people were arrested in Karnataka earlier, while the total number of arrests in the case has now reached 10.

The agency had also searched quarry-related locations in Kozhikode, Kasaragod and Kannur districts before arresting the suspects.

Kerala govt. may withdraw directive on Vande Mataram

Following Opposition allegations of ‘toeing RSS line’, Health Minister says only the first two stanzas would be sung at State govt. programmes; CMO is yet to officially clarify or withdraw instruction

The Hindu Bureau
THIRUVANANTHAPURAM

Following Opposition allegations of toeing the Sangh Parivar’s line on the recital of *Vande Mataram* in its entirety, the Congress-led United Democratic Front (UDF) government in Kerala appeared to backtrack on the Chief Secretary’s directive to government departments to ensure the song was recited in its entirety during the Independence Day celebrations.

Although the Chief Minister’s Office is yet to make an official clarification or withdraw the directive, Health Minister K. Muraleedharan told the media on Sunday that only the



The Health Minister says that the Chief Secretary sometimes issues circulars based on Union government directives. FILE PHOTO

first two stanzas will be sung in the State government’s programmes. He said that the Chief Secretary sometimes issues circulars based on Union government directives. Though Mr. Muraleedharan and Education Minister N. Samsudheen of the Indian Union Muslim League (IUML) said that the Chief Secretary had acted as per Lok Bhavan’s directives, Lok Bhavan has reportedly denied issuing any directions.

Even as the Opposition

Left Democratic Front (LDF) lashed out at the UDF government for “surrendering completely” to the Rashtriya Swayamsevak Sangh’s (RSS) agenda, the Ministers of the ruling front had found it hard to defend the directive.

Opposition’s criticism

Leader of the Opposition Pinarayi Vijayan said that singing the first two stanzas of *Vande Mataram* was not wrong, but the song in its entirety goes against the country’s secular spirit.

CPI(M) leader T.M. Thomas Isaac said that even though in a federal system States might be forced to follow Central directives, the State should at least make a mark of protest.

Karnataka portfolios set to be announced

The Hindu Bureau
BENGALURU

With the Monsoon Session of the legislature set to begin on August 13, the Congress government in Karnataka is likely to allocate portfolios to the 19 newly sworn-in Ministers on Monday.

While the new Ministers were sworn in amid confusion, revolt, and last-minute changes last Monday, the discussion on portfolio

allocation is still under way. Party sources said that portfolio allocation has become difficult owing to insistence by the Ministers on getting portfolios of their choice.

Chief Minister D.K. Shivakumar left for Delhi on Sunday to meet the Congress Central leadership and hand over the list of possible portfolios for the Ministers. “The list is likely to be finalised by Monday,” government sources said.

Kerala Police arrest Hindutva ideologue

The Hindu Bureau
KOCHI

The Kerala police on Sunday took into custody Hindutva ideologue T.G. Mohandas for his alleged inflammatory statements made in connection with the youth protest at Jantar Mantar in New Delhi.

Mr. Mohandas, a former head of the Bharatiya Janata Party’s (BJP) State intellectual cell, had stated in a YouTube video that he

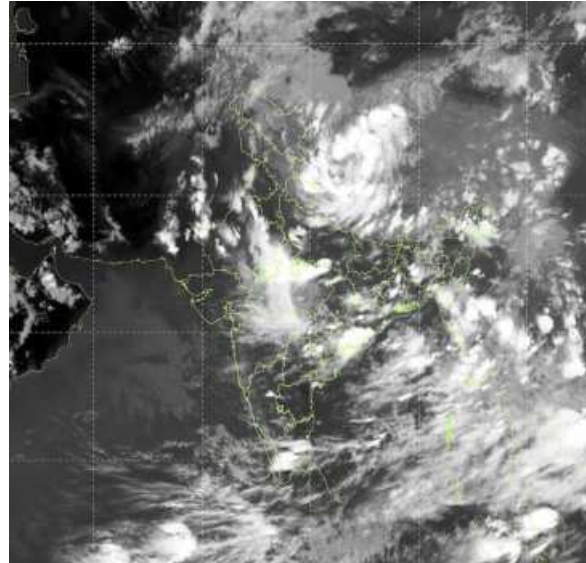
would have ordered a curfew at the protest site and shot the student protesters if he were in control.

In another video, he said secular women who take part in protests “enjoy being gang-raped”.

A team of cyber police officers had carried out searches at his Mattancherry residence on Sunday afternoon. He would be taken to Thiruvananthapuram, a police officer said.

WEATHERWATCH

Rainfall, temperature & air quality in select metros yesterday



TEMPERATURE DATA: IMD, POLLUTION DATA: CPCB, MAP: INSAT/IMD (TAKEN AT 17.00 HRS)

Forecast for Monday: Heavy to Very Heavy Rainfall very likely at isolated places over Himachal Pradesh, Uttarakhand and West Madhya Pradesh. Thunderstorm accompanied with Lightning very likely at isolated places over Arunachal Pradesh, Assam & Meghalaya, Chhattisgarh, Gujarat Region, Maharashtra, Nagaland, Manipur, Mizoram and Tripura and Uttarakhand.

CITY	RAIN	MAX	MIN	CITY	RAIN	MAX	MIN
Agartala		31.5	26.5	Kurnool		35.5	25.4
Ahmedabad		33.7	27.0	Lucknow		33.5	27.8
Aizawl		27.3	22.4	Madurai		40.2	26.1
Bangaluru		4.4	29.4	Mangaluru		29.1	24.4
Bhopal				Mumbai			
Bhubaneswar		6.2	34.2	Mysuru		29.0	20.0
Chandigarh			36.0	New Delhi		4.8	35.3
Chennai		17.8	36.1	Patna			34.9
Coimbatore			33.4	Prayagraj		17.8	29.4
Dehradun		2.5	32.2	Puducherry			25.0
Gangtok		43	22.3	Pune			30.2
Goa		18	31.4	Raipur		66	30.0
Guwahati		25.9	32.9	Ranchi		7	29.9
Hubballi				Shillong		0.2	23.3
Hyderabad		12.4		Shimla			24.1
Imphal		3.8	27.7	Srinagar		0.7	30.4
Jaipur			00.0	Thiruvananthapuram		17.3	31.0
Kochi		3	29.6	Tiruchirappalli			39.5
Kohima				Vijayawada			
Kolkata			32.0	Visakhapatnam		5.2	34.0
Kozhikode		6.6	31.9				

(Rainfall data in mm; temperature in Celsius)

Pollutants in the air you are breathing

CITIES	SO ₂	NO ₂	CO	PM _{2.5}	PM ₁₀	CODE	Yesterday
Ahmedabad		11	23	27		114	In observation made at 4.00 p.m., Hingoli,
Bangaluru		8		52	31	87	Maharashtra recorded an
Chennai		6	12		34	89	overall air quality index
Delhi		20	31	81		173	(AQI) score of 336
Hyderabad		4	18	14	27	57	indicating an unhealthy
Jaipur		5	15	35	19	30	level of pollution. In
Kolkata		36	12	24	69	84	contrast, Aizawl, Mizoram
Lucknow		4	4	10	30	80	recorded a healthy AQI
Mumbai			27	2	39	82	score of 14.
Pune			27	2	39	82	
Visakhapatnam		6	11	20	49	89	

Air Quality Code: Poor Moderate Good (Readings indicate average AQI)

SO₂: Sulphur Dioxide. Short-term exposure can harm the respiratory system, making breathing difficult. It can affect visibility by reacting with other air particles to form haze and stain culturally important objects such as statues and monuments.

NO₂: Nitrogen Dioxide. Aggravates respiratory illness, causes haze to form by reacting with other air particles, causes acid rain, pollutes coastal waters.

CO: Carbon monoxide. High concentration in air reduces oxygen supply to critical organs like the heart and brain. At very high levels, it can cause dizziness, confusion, unconsciousness and even death.

PM_{2.5} & PM₁₀: Particulate matter pollution can cause irritation of the eyes, nose and throat, coughing, chest tightness and shortness of breath, reduced lung function, irregular heartbeat, asthma attacks, heart attacks and premature death in people with heart or lung disease

Cultural showcase



Indigenous rhythms: Kommu Koya tribal dancers perform during the World’s Indigenous Peoples Day celebration at Kumram Bheem Adivasi Bhavan in Hyderabad on Sunday. SIDDHANT THAKUR

A.P. govt. will protect rights of tribal youth, says Naidu

The Hindu Bureau
VIJAYAWADA

Chief Minister N. Chandrababu Naidu said on Sunday that the Andhra Pradesh government was working on an alternative mechanism to protect employment opportunities for tribal youth, following the striking down of G.O. No. 3, while setting a 2027 deadline for ensuring every tribal family in the State had access to safe drinking water and housing.

Struck down by SC

The GO No. 3, issued in 2000 to reserve 100% of teacher posts in the Scheduled Areas for the local tribal candidates, was

struck down by the Supreme Court in 2020, prompting Mr. Naidu to explore a legally sustainable alternative to protect tribal youth employment. The G.O. remained a major issue for tribal communities, with the tribal groups protesting its scrapping and demanding restoration of safeguards for local youth in government employment.

Addressing the International Day of the World’s Indigenous Peoples programme, Mr. Naidu said the government was committed to protecting the rights of tribal communities.

Mr. Naidu said ₹4,764 crore had been allocated for the comprehensive de-

velopment of 27.39 lakh tribal people, with focus on infrastructure, livelihoods, employment and skill development through the Integrated Tribal Development Agencies (ITDAs).

He also stressed the need to increase tribal incomes through value addition, processing and branding of forest produce such as Seethampeta turmeric, Rampachodavaram rubber, Parvathipuram pineapple, honey and palm jaggery.

As many as 1.5 lakh tribal youth would be provided skill training, while special initiatives would be taken to prepare tribal students for competitive examinations, he said.

Combined effects of climate and geology caused 2024 Wayanad landslide: study

Sam Paul A.
KOZHIKODE

The devastating 2024 landslide in Kerala’s Wayanad cannot be attributed to extreme rainfall alone but was also likely influenced by geological, geomorphological and structural factors, according to a new study published in the international peer-reviewed journal *Landslides*.

The study, published on the journal’s website, notes that while intense monsoon rain triggered the collapse, underlying geological conditions influenced where the landslide began, how it travelled, and why it became one of the most destructive landslide re-



The researchers conducted extensive field investigations across the affected valley in April 2025. FILE PHOTO

coded in the Western Ghats. It was conducted by researchers from the University of Kerala, Indian Institute of Science Education and Research (IISER) Mohali, and Savitribai Phule Pune University.

To understand why the landslide became so destructive, the researchers conducted extensive field investigations across the affected valley in April 2025. Geological mapping was carried out from Chooral-

Video of BJP leader’s Bidadi issue remarks goes viral

The Hindu Bureau
SHIVAMOGGA/BENGALURU

The Opposition Bharatiya Janata Party and its State president B.Y. Vijayendra faced embarrassment after a video of Mr. Vijayendra purportedly saying that the party was extending “symbolic” support to the cause of the Bidadi Township Project and that the farmers were gradually accepting the compensation, went viral on Sunday.

The video showed a casual conversation between Karnataka Minister Madhu Bangarappa and Mr. Vijayendra, who is also the MLA of Shikaripur, at a drought review meeting held in Shikaripur on Saturday.

mala to Punchirimattam, while rock samples were analysed in the laboratory. As the landslide crown remained unsafe to access, drone-mounted LiDAR and high-resolution aerial imagery were used to investigate it.

“The study reveals the interplay of climate and geology. Extreme rainfall acted as the immediate trigger, but the pre-existing geological framework determined where the slope failed, how the debris moved and why the event became exceptionally destructive,” said Y. Anilkumar and K.S. Sajinkumar, assistant professors at the Department of Geology, University of Kerala.



Will strongly oppose FCRA Bill in Parliament: Congress

Mizoram Chief Minister, Christian bodies appeal to Shah to roll back FCRA Bill

BJP MP lists Bill on restriction of social media for children

Mamata faces protests during visit to house of deceased party worker

Biju Janata Dal sees opportunity to regain political ground in Odisha

Shah must answer for action against students, says Rahul

CM
Y
K

If your NPS corpus is too small

COVERNOTE

K. Nitya Kalyani

“What’s the point of receiving a pension of just a few hundred rupees a month?” an acquaintance asked me recently. We were discussing the Pension Fund Regulatory and Development Authority’s (PFRDA) revised exit rules for the National Pension System (NPS). It is a fair question. At a certain age, you begin to simplify life. Activities reduce, commitments turn fewer, unnecessary work is quietly dropped and somehow the little glass figurines in the showcase disappear as well! Investments get streamlined, portfolios are consolidated, scattered mutual fund folios merged and the lone fixed deposit in a distant bank is redeemed. The objective is not merely to maximise returns but to make life simpler. For some people, an NPS account now falls into that category. This is not true for everyone. But if you shifted to the new tax regime, no longer receive additional tax deduction for NPS contributions and accumulated only a modest corpus, it may be time to review if continuing the account still serves financial goals. Why discuss NPS in an insurance column? Because the NPS end game is purchase of an annuity viz. a pension



Little use: If the corpus is small, the pension generated is likely to be modest.

product offered by life insurers. And why now? Because the revised PFRDA rules have made it easier for some subscribers to exit.

Changing equation

If the NPS corpus is up to ₹8 lakh, you can withdraw the full amount without purchasing an annuity. Earlier, part of the corpus had to be compulsorily used to buy one. For many investors, that changes the equation. An annuity has its place. It provides an income for life, something few financial products can promise. But if the corpus is small, the pension it generates is likely to be modest. A corpus of about ₹8 lakh may translate into an annual pension of roughly ₹5,000, depending on age and option chosen. Some investors may decide they would rather deploy the money elsewhere.

Large corpus, more choices

If your corpus is larger, you have more choices. You can continue with NPS, defer exit, withdraw a part of the corpus and use the balance to buy an annuity or simply keep the account without making fresh contributions. The right answer depends on overall retirement income not NPS alone.

Advantage of buying annuity

There is another point worth remembering. Buying an annuity via NPS has one important advantage: there is no GST on the purchase. Your entire amount goes towards buying the pension. Outside NPS, GST is payable. Depending on corpus size, this benefit can be meaningful. The new rules are therefore not an invitation to exit NPS. They are an opportunity to rethink it. Retirement planning is not only about accumulating investments. It is also about knowing when to simplify them. If your NPS account has become a small holding that no longer offers tax benefits and adds little to your retirement income, this may be the right time to decide whether it still deserves a place in your portfolio. (The writer is a business journalist specialising in insurance & corporate history.)

Send queries on personal finance and investing to the moneywise@thehindu.co.in ID. Our experts in personal finance will respond to select queries, but will not give specific recommendations for investment in a particular mutual fund, share or fixed deposit.

MONEYWISE



ILLUSTRATION: SAAI

Mutual Fund flows and takeaways for you

Investors are staying invested despite volatility, getting comfortable delegating market-cap allocation decisions to fund managers and warming up to one-stop asset allocation via MAFs

FLOW CHART

Joydeep Sen

Mutual Funds (MFs) come in multiple categories, spanning equity, debt and hybrid structures. Tracking categories receiving more flows than others give us a clue on what a majority of investors are preferring at a point in time. You have to gauge which category is suitable for your risk appetite and time horizon. Two categories have been excluded from this analysis. One is Sectoral/Thematic Funds since the AMFI data for this category is a cumulation of multiple sub-categories from banking to infrastructure to pharma and is not comparable with other single-strategy categories. The other exclusion is Liquid Funds as this is dominated by corporate investors parking treasury money. Our data source for this piece is the AMFI Monthly Note.

Flexi Cap leads flows

The category receiving the highest flows from December 2025 to June 2026 is Flexi Cap funds. Gross flows, before redemptions, has been ₹55,225 crore. Here, the fund manager faces no curbs in allocation to large-, mid- or small-cap stocks and is entirely at manager’s discretion. Given the flexibility, strategy varies from one AMC to another. That said, there is a general bias to-

In Flexi-cap funds, the fund manager faces no curbs in allocation to large-, mid- or small-cap stocks and is entirely at the discretion of the fund manager

wards large caps in most such portfolios since they are relatively less volatile vis-a-vis mid- or small-caps, cushioning the fund in times of market stress. The inference is instructive. Though equity market has been somewhat volatile, that investors are continuing to build portfolios is a sign of their growing maturity. It also tells us investors are comfortable with the fund manager handling market-cap allocation decision. That is the value proposition a Flexi Cap fund offers which investors seem to be recognising.

Multi-assets gain

The next most popular category in terms of flows over the last seven months is Multi-asset allocation funds or MAFs under which gross flow was ₹45,453 crore. A MAF combines three or more asset classes such as equity, debt, global equity, gold, silver, REITs and InvITs in a single fund structure. Rather than investors buying separate equity, debt and gold funds and then manage the allocation, a single MAF does the

As fewer taxpayers find it worthwhile to stay in the Old Tax Regime to claim this deduction, the flow of fresh money into ELSS funds has naturally tapered off

job. This imparts the benefit of asset allocation in one product and inculcates discipline. When the intended allocation ratio gets altered, for instance if equity rallies and weight in portfolio rises beyond the target, the fund manager books profit in equity and rebalances towards the original ratio. If investors were to attempt this on their own, there would be a tax implication every time they switched funds. MAF Inflows picked up after equity turned volatile after September 2024. The rally in gold prices till February contributed to MAFs positive sentiment.

Mid-, small-cap flows

The other two categories seeing buoyant flows over the last seven months are Mid-cap and Small-cap funds. Valuations of mid-cap and small-cap stocks are relatively stretched compared with large caps. The risk level in the categories is relatively higher and investor must have a long investment horizon to ride out the volatility coming with it. The one category consistently losing corpus is

Equity Linked Savings Schemes (ELSS).

ELSS funds lose

The primary motivation for investing in ELSS was the tax benefit under Section 80C of the Income Tax Act, now Section 123 of the new Income Tax Act. Given the New Tax Regime is more beneficial for an overwhelming majority of the IT payers, the Old Tax Regime and the relevance of Section 80C (now Section 123) deductions is steadily losing charm. As fewer taxpayers find it worthwhile to stay in the Old Tax Regime to claim this deduction, the flow of fresh money into ELSS funds has naturally tapered off.

The takeaway

Data across categories tells a fairly coherent story. Investors are staying invested despite volatility, increasingly getting comfortable delegating market-cap allocation decisions to fund managers via Flexi Cap funds and warming up to the idea of one-stop asset allocation via MAFs. At the same time, elevated flows into Mid- and Small-cap funds call for caution than imitation. As always, use this as a reference point for what the market at large is doing and then map it against goals, risk appetite and time horizon before deciding what is right for you. Popularity and suitability are not the same. (Joydeep Sen is a corporate trainer (financial markets) and author)

Transfer to core from satellite?

THINKINVESTOR

You can transfer gains from your satellite to a core portfolio but not the other way around; this constraint is very important to protect the excess gains you may have in any of your core portfolios

Venkatesh Bangaruswamy

Previously in this column, we discussed the benefits of creating and managing a satellite portfolio; you can use the gains from the satellite portfolio to bridge a shortfall in any of core portfolios. What if there is no shortfall and the satellite portfolio is generating handsome gains? Here, we discuss why you should not transfer money from core to satellite portfolio.

Market timing

If you pursue three life goals, you should have three core portfolios. The portfolio with the longest time horizon will be retirement portfolio to accumulate wealth to meet post retirement expenses. When the satellite portfolio is generating handsome gains, you may be tempted to raise trading capital by transferring money from retirement portfolio. The argument could be retirement is far away and you can bridge any shortfall during the last 10 years of working life. There are, however, two factors to be mindful of.

Market timing, skill, luck

One, the satellite portfolio is about market timing involving skill and luck. If you have a period of bad luck, you could lose a huge part of the money transferred from the core to the satellite portfolio. Recovering losses is more difficult than giving-up gains of the same magnitude. For instance, 50% unrealised losses require 100% appreciation in value to recover the loss but 50% unrealised gains requires only 33% dip to wipe-out the gains. Two, if you are tempted to transfer excess returns in any core portfolio to the satellite portfolio, think about this.

Suppose you expect 12% pre-tax return on equity investment in child’s education portfolio. If the investment were to experience 14% return, it would be optimal to take out the excess returns of two percentage points and create a fixed deposit. The deposit can be used as capital when actual return on equity investments in any year is less than 12% during the remaining time horizon for the goal.

Conclusion

You can transfer gains from your satellite to a core portfolio but not the other way around. This constraint is important to protect excess gains you may have in any of your core portfolios. Such gains can be also used as buffer capital to account for inflation risk, as the amount needed to achieve the goal can increase because of inflation. (The author offers training programmes for individuals to manage their personal investments)

Bank Fixed Deposit Rates

Bank Name	Interest Rates (%)			
	Highest Slab	1-year Tenure	3-year Tenure	5-year Tenure
Small Finance Banks				
AU Small Finance Bank	7.40	6.35	7.40	6.75
Equitas Small Finance Bank	8.00	7.10	7.10	7.00
ESAF Small Finance Bank	7.75	6.00	6.00	5.75
Jana Small Finance Bank	8.00	7.00	8.00	7.77
Shivalik Small Finance Bank	8.00	6.00	7.50	6.25
slice Small Finance Bank	7.75	6.25	7.50	7.00
Suryoday Small Finance Bank	8.10	7.25	7.25	7.90
Ujjivan Small Finance Bank	7.80	7.25	7.25	7.20
Utkarsh Small Finance Bank	8.10	6.00	7.50	7.00
Private Sector Banks				
Axis Bank	6.50	6.25	6.50	6.50
Bandhan Bank	7.45	7.00	7.25	5.85
City Union Bank	7.25	6.65	6.50	6.55
CSB Bank	7.35	5.00	5.75	5.75
DBS Bank	6.85	6.30	6.40	6.25
DCB Bank	7.50	6.90	7.00	7.50
Federal Bank	6.70	6.25	6.40	6.40
HDFC Bank	6.50	6.25	6.45	6.40
ICICI Bank	6.50	6.25	6.45	6.50
IDFC FIRST Bank	7.25	6.50	7.25	6.75
IndusInd Bank	7.00	6.75	7.00	6.65

Bank Name	Interest Rates (%)			
	Highest Slab	1-year Tenure	3-year Tenure	5-year Tenure
Public Sector Banks				
Jammu & Kashmir Bank	7.05	6.55	6.80	6.85
IDBI Bank	6.50	6.20	6.35	6.25
Karnataka Bank	7.00	6.50	6.15	6.15
Kotak Mahindra Bank	6.80	6.35	6.40	6.25
RBL Bank	7.20	7.00	7.20	6.70
SBM Bank India	7.30	7.10	7.10	7.00
South Indian Bank	6.80	6.25	6.20	5.70
Tamilnad Mercantile Bank	7.25	6.80	6.70	6.70
YES Bank	7.25	6.65	7.00	6.75
Public Sector Banks				
Bank of Baroda	6.75	6.25	6.25	6.30
Bank of India	6.85	6.50	6.70	6.00
Bank of Maharashtra	6.65	6.40	5.25	5.00
Canara Bank	6.60	6.25	6.25	6.25
Central Bank of India	6.70	6.10	6.00	6.00
Indian Bank	6.65	6.10	6.05	6.00
Indian Overseas Bank	6.60	6.50	6.10	6.10
Punjab National Bank	6.60	6.25	6.30	6.35
Punjab & Sind Bank	6.85	5.85	5.85	5.95
State Bank of India	6.45	6.25	6.30	6.05
Union Bank of India	6.55	6.20	6.10	6.00

Home Loan Interest Rates

Name of Lender	Loan Amount (Rs.)		
	Upto 30 lakh	Above 30 lakh & upto 75 lakh	Above 75 lakh
(In %)			
Public Sector Banks			
State Bank of India	7.25-9.05	7.25-9.05	7.25-9.05
Bank of Baroda	7.20-9.00	7.20-9.00	7.20-9.25
Union Bank of India*	7.15-9.60	7.15-9.60	7.15-9.60
Punjab National Bank	7.30-9.30	7.25-9.20	7.25-9.20
Bank of India	7.10-10.00	7.10-10.00	7.10-10.25
Bank of Maharashtra	7.00-9.90	7.00-9.90	7.00-9.90
Punjab and Sind Bank	7.35-10.75	7.35-10.75	7.35-10.75
Indian Overseas Bank	7.20 #	7.20 #	7.20 #
Indian Bank	7.15-9.55	7.15-9.55	7.15-9.55
Central Bank of India	7.10-9.15	7.10-9.15	7.10-9.15
Private Sector Banks			
Kotak Mahindra Bank	7.60 #	7.60 #	7.60 #
ICICI Bank	7.50 #	7.50 #	7.50 #
Axis Bank	8.00-11.90	8.00-11.90	8.00 - 9.10
HSBC Bank	7.45 #	7.45 #	7.45 #
South Indian Bank	7.20 #	7.20 #	7.20 #
Karur Vysya Bank	8.50-10.65	8.50-10.65	8.50-10.65
Karnataka Bank	7.48-11.80	7.48-11.80	7.48-11.80
Federal Bank	8.35 - 10.25	7.35 - 10.25	7.35 - 9.25

Name of Lender	Loan Amount (Rs.)		
	Upto 30 lakh	Above 30 lakh & upto 75 lakh	Above 75 lakh
(In %)			
Tamilnad Mercantile Bank			
Bandhan Bank	8.55 - 13.52	8.55 - 13.52	8.55 - 13.52
RBL Bank	8.20 #	8.20 #	8.20 #
CSB Bank	8.30 #	8.30 #	8.30 #
HDFC Bank	7.75 #	7.75 #	7.75 #
City Union Bank	8.25-9.50	8.50-10.00	8.75-10.50
Housing Finance Companies (HFCs)			
LIC Housing Finance	7.15 #	7.15 #	7.15 #
Bajaj Housing Finance	7.25 #	7.25 #	7.25 #
Tata Capital	8.00 #	8.00 #	8.00 #
PNB Housing Finance	7.75-14.50	7.80-14.50	7.50-9.95
GIC Housing Finance	8.20 #	8.20 #	8.20 #
SMFG India Home Finance	9.25 #	9.25 #	9.25 #
Sammaan Capital	8.75 #	8.75 #	8.75 #
Aditya Birla Capital	7.75 #	7.75 #	7.75 #
ICICI Home Finance	7.50 #	7.50 #	7.50 #
Godrej Housing Finance	7.65 #	7.65 #	7.65 #
*Extra interest rate concession of 0.05% to borrowers opting for insurance policy. Rates as on August 5 #onwards Source:Paisabazaar.com			

WASHINGTON

Former U.S. President Joe Biden's cancer has spread further, says son



Former U.S. President Joe Biden's prostate cancer has metastasised further, according to his son Hunter Biden, who shared the update in an interview with the BBC. Mr. Hunter said his father's disease has spread despite the treatment. "It's very painful, and it's very debilitating in many respects, but he's still out there," he said. AFP

ISLAMABAD

Mecca pact with Saudi Arabia and Turkiye 'purely defensive': Pakistan



Pakistan's Foreign Minister Ishaq Dar said on Sunday the landmark Mecca Joint Defence Agreement his country signed with Saudi Arabia and Turkiye was not directed against any country and remained open to other nations in the region. In a post on X, Mr. Dar said the agreement was "purely defensive in nature". AP

DAMASCUS

Syria reaches understanding with Moscow on future of Russian bases



Syria and Russia have reached a memorandum of understanding on the fate of Russian bases at Tartous and Hmeimim after 18 months of talks. Syria's Foreign Ministry said on Sunday Damascus would take over management of civilian facilities, including Hmeimim airport and the commercial berth at Tartous port. REUTERS

BANGKOK

Thai teen school shooter watched violent content online, police say



The Thai teen behind a deadly school shooting on August 7 outside Bangkok had an air gun confiscated by a teacher last year and had watched violent content online, police said on Sunday, as the government promised new safety protocols for schools. Eight people died in Thailand's worst mass shooting since 2022. REUTERS

Trump says U.S. going 'low key' as Tehran firm on Hormuz demands

U.S. President says his administration is only 'semi-negotiating', will wait and watch economic pressure mount on Iran; Hormuz deal with Oman in final stages, says Araghchi, reiterates U.S. must fulfil conditions for reopening of key waterway

Reuters
DUBAI/WASHINGTON/CAIRO

U.S. President Donald Trump signalled on Sunday he is prepared to let economic pressure mount against Iran, apparently backing away from ordering more military strikes even as Tehran issues tough demands.

"We are low-keying it," Mr. Trump said, according to the news outlet Axios.

Iranian Foreign Minister Abbas Araghchi said on Sunday that a deal with Oman defining new shipping lanes in the Strait of Hormuz was in its "final stages" but repeated comments made on Saturday



Silent watch: A banner with an image of Supreme Leader Mojtaba Khamenei at Valiasr Square in Tehran on Saturday. AFP

that it would not reopen the waterway unless other conditions were met. He also denied on Sunday that Iran was negotiating with the U.S., saying they were merely "exchanging messages" via intermediaries.

The strait's blockage by Iran since the war started has sent fuel prices soaring and rattled the world economy, putting pressure on the Trump administration as midterm elections in November grow nearer.

"We are only semi-negotiating with them. We are just watching Iran with its huge inflation and the fact they have no money," Mr. Trump was quoted as saying.

Iran's Revolutionary Guards also reiterated on Sunday that they would not reopen the strait until demands were met, including U.S. compensation for war damage. The strategy was to maintain the closure "until the enemy accepts all our conditions... the strait is now actually a theatre of war for us and not just a waterway", the Guards said.

The conditions listed include ending U.S. threats against Iran, stopping aggression against Iran and its Lebanese, Palestinian, Yemeni and Iraqi allies, lifting a blockade and sanctions on Iran and freeing Iranian assets.

Rare meet

Iranian state media said on Sunday that President Masoud Pezeshkian had met Supreme Leader Mojtaba Khamenei in late July and a paramilitary leader has promised new footage of the Supreme Leader, who has not been seen in public since being reportedly injured in the air strike that killed his father and predecessor on February 28, the first day of U.S.-Israeli air strikes on Iran.

(With inputs from AFP)

7 killed as Russia, Ukraine exchange overnight strikes

Associated Press
KYIV

Russia and Ukraine exchanged strikes overnight that killed civilians and injured many others on both sides, local authorities reported on Sunday.

Ukrainian drones killed five people and injured two dozen others, including a 4-year-old boy, in Russia's border region of Belgorod, according to the regional administration.

In Kharkiv, Ukraine's second-largest city, Russian missiles struck a high-rise apartment block in the Saltivskiy district, killing two people and injuring 13, according to regional head Oleh Syniehubov.

Eight people were injured in Ukraine's Black Sea port of Odesa after "dozens of missiles and



Aftermath of attack: Burned cars at the site of a Russian air raid in Odesa, Ukraine on Sunday. AFP

drones" struck the city, according to local officials.

Ukraine's President Volodymyr Zelenskyy said the seaport had been damaged by the strike.

Large-scale Russian missile strikes on Ukrainian cities have become almost routine in recent weeks, with Moscow exploiting Ukraine's critical shortage of interceptors for the U.S.-made Patriot systems – the sole air defence weapon in its arsenal able to shoot down ballistic missiles.

Meanwhile, Kyiv has kept up long-range drone strikes against Russian energy infrastructure, as well as the country's largest online retailer, Wildberries, and other targets deep inside Russia, sparking a fuel crisis.

Bombings mark first day in office for new Colombian President

Agence France-Presse
BOGOTA

Two bombing attacks in different parts of Colombia on Saturday marked the first day in office for new President Abelardo de la Espriella, leaving at least one police officer dead and several wounded.

The tough-talking hard-right leader campaigned on confronting "narcoterrorism without truce" and ending peace talks with armed groups following his inauguration on Friday in the city of Cali.

His inauguration comes during the worst wave of violence the country has experienced in the last decade.

Colombia's Army said FARC guerilla dissidents used explosives to destroy a highway tollbooth near Cali in the early hours of Saturday.

Mr. De la Espriella condemned the bombing, saying "attacking the country's infrastructure is attacking progress" in an X post. "To those responsible, I send a clear message: there will be no refuge, no leniency and no impunity," he added.

About 1,000 kilometres away, in the northern department of Cesar, an officer was killed in another bombing when an explosive-equipped drone struck a police station, officials said.

Wildfire in western Canada forces over 20,000 evacuations

Agence France-Presse
VICTORIA

Canadian officials declared a state of emergency on Saturday after a fast-moving wildfire in the western province of British Columbia forced the overnight evacuation of more than 20,000 people.

Winds fanned the Bald Range wildfire to grow rapidly late on Friday, pushing flames into the Summerland area and affecting communities throughout the surrounding valleys.

"We know there have been significant losses of property. We also know that some people became trapped as conditions changed quickly," British

Columbia Premier David Eby said in a statement.

"Air evacuations are under way for people who remain isolated behind the fire perimeter," Mr. Eby said.

The Bald Range fire covered an estimated area of 25,552 acres as of early Sunday, according to the BC Wildfire Service website. It reported a total of 102 active wildfires in the province as of early Sunday, with nearly half of them deemed out of control.

Kelly Greene, the province's Minister of Emergency Management and Climate Readiness, declared a state of emergency.

Pentagon pushes for faster weapons production amid stockpile shortage

Associated Press
WASHINGTON

The Pentagon is pressing the U.S. defence industry to accelerate production of weapons to help replenish its diminished stockpile of munitions, including those depleted in the ongoing war with Iran.

Pentagon spokesman Sean Parnell said in a statement on Saturday that the department was actively focused on boosting munitions acquisitions to provide "the weapons our warfighters need at the pace the threat demands." He confirmed department efforts in the last week to significantly speed the process but insisted it was part of a broader modernisation effort that predated the five-month-old conflict.

Deputy Defence Secretary Steve Feinberg wrote to industry leaders on Wednesday, giving them no more than 21 days to



THAAD interceptor inventories fell from 452 before the Iran war to roughly 232-262 in April, according to U.S. think tank CSIS. REUTERS

submit plans to "drive significantly faster, more aggressive delivery schedules and/or increased production for critical capabilities," according to a memo obtained by The Washington Post.

However, President Donald Trump has bristled over public reports of a munitions shortage, posting on Truth Social on Thursday that the U.S. has "massive amounts."

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'Kuldeep took a break to assess body, not due to fitness concern'



Gill takes his preparation very seriously, says Bahutule



World No. 1 Sinner withdraws from Cincinnati Open with knee injury



Ashmita stuns Han to bag her maiden BWF Tour title

Coach Park, who has now seen two of his wards win Super 300 tournaments in successive weeks, believes the Assam girl always had the tools to succeed, wants her to be more consistent



Sarfraz replaces the injured Sai Sudharsan in Test squad

There is brilliant coordination between CoE and Indian team management, insists Laxman



 We definitely appreciate your suggestion to see whether the final can be hosted in a stadium

Jaiswal and Gill find form as India canter to a victory in warm-up game

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H. Kalpana Rao

Often, when I am introduced as a professor of English, the immediate response is “Oh, I need to be careful when I speak to you in English.” Such comments point to a widespread confusion between language proficiency and the study of literature. This is a misconception that needs clarification.

Literature is more content-driven and deals with ideas and experiences and communicates to the reader through an emotional quotient. On the other hand, language is more about the structural aspects, such as understanding grammar, vocabulary, and syntax, and about knowing the underlying structure.

Language training

An important need in higher education today is training in language. This is not to say that literature students are unable to use language.

They do but in a different way. They can analyse and deconstruct plots, stories, and narratives, explore cultural nuances, recognise discrimination, ponder social and political backdrops, and identify the plural meanings that a text offers. Yet, they are unable to draft an essay with the nuanced perspective by which they read a text.

We need to, therefore, find a methodology to improve this. One solution is to set up a language centre that can provide training in English language skills and help scholars and students in academic writing. It is not just literature students



GETTY IMAGES/STOCKPHOTO

who lack the skills necessary to author academic articles.

Students and scholars in the sciences and other fields also find it difficult to communicate their research ideas clearly. This lack of language proficiency also has implications for employability, as students and scholars struggle to write clear resumes, articulate confidently in interviews, and communicate well in professional settings.

In the case of researchers, inadequate language skills limit their ability to produce well-structured dissertations or critically engaged conference papers. Over time, these issues also erode confidence and make students hesitate to participate boldly and positively in academic forums.

Improved presentation
Another lacuna lies in presentation skills. Too often,

scholars, including faculty members, prepare dull slides and speak without preparation, leading to frequent miscommunication and a sense of boredom among listeners. Therefore, a language centre may help by providing support to prepare strong, attractive slides and offering training in seminar presentations and speaking coherently. Additionally, it could also offer structured modules in grammar, vocabulary building, academic writing, and critical reading, along with workshops on citation practices, editing skills and communication.

Such a centre might also collaborate with different departments by designing specific writing sessions such as scientific writing for science students, report writing for social sciences, and research papers for humanities. The centre could be staffed by

English language tutors who combine strong language skills with patience and a supportive approach to learners. Many universities abroad run such writing centres and communication labs that function as academic support hubs offering consultations and skill sustenance across the university.

It is significant that higher education institutions recognise that language is not merely a medium of in-

struction but a tool for thinking, shaping how students organise ideas, construct arguments and engage intellectually at a global level. This does not mean that literature is not necessary. On the other hand, literature nurtures critical consciousness by providing readers to analyse varied perspectives, recognise power structures, and explore the complexities of human experience. Higher educa-

tion needs both these dimensions to exist side by side so that learners understand how language enables clear, precise communication and how literature cultivates insight and empathy through in-depth interpretations.

The writer is a former professor of English at Pondicherry University and now volunteers as the editor for the literary section of the online journal, Muse India. Email: hkalp.eng@pondiuni.ac.in

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Pant — an enigma at the crossroads

Having been replaced as India's Test vice-captain, he can focus on his primary disciplines without having to attend lengthy team discussions or the distraction of being pulled in different directions; the team needs the most potent version of the player to come to the fore

R. Kaushik

When we talk one-format India internationals in the current milieu, almost all the focus is on India's two immediate all-format past skippers. Since May 2025, when they bid adieu to Test cricket within weeks of each other, Rohit Sharma and Virat Kohli play for the country only in One-Day Internationals, having already announced their retirement from T20Is at the conclusion of a triumphant World T20 campaign in Bridgetown in June 2024.

There has been so much talk about whether one, or both, or neither, will be present at next year's 50-over World Cup in southern Africa that most other issues have been relegated to the background. Including the fact that there is another high-profile one-format-only international in recent times, a young man who has completed a decade in India colours but is now at a tenuous crossroads after an eminently forgettable last few months.

As India embarked on a journey of transition, replete with excitement and promise, last summer through a five-Test tour of England, it was expected that the future would be shaped by two of the most luminous gems in the Indian firmament. Shubman Gill's elevation to the Test captaincy was no surprise, even though he didn't have a great deal of leadership experience at the First Class level. Gill had time on his side, he was even then one of the top batters whose place wasn't under threat, and he had shown himself to be a quick learner. Thrust into the role of his deputy was a once-fearless force of nature who had been forced by circumstances to temper his exuberance, both because of extraneous pressure and owing to the fact that, having established himself as one of the seniors within the setup, he had to strike a fine balance between carefree and careless batsmanship.

Rishabh Pant's rise as the vice-captain of the Test side was welcomed with as much breathless anticipation as Gill's to the captaincy. Or Pant's arrival at the batting crease, if you like. With the chunky left-hander, you still don't know what to expect. Or maybe you do, but even so, what he does simply blows your mind. Pant isn't reckless; he isn't someone who doesn't not put a price on his wicket, though from time to time, 'Stupid, stupid, stupid' will surface because that's just who he is. Successive coaches, from Ravi Shastri to Rahul Dravid to now Gautam Gambhir, have given him the licence to be himself with the rider that he should be a little more selective, a little more game-aware, a little more respectful of situations and conditions.

It might have been tough for Gambhir to reconcile, for instance, to Pant's extravagant aerial drive to his fifth delivery, from off-spinner Ramesh Mendis, that nestled in long-off's hands at the NCC ground on Saturday in India's only practice game, against a Sri Lanka Cricket XI. Most other batters would have been happy to play themselves in, get some circulation going, get a feel of the conditions, prepare conservatively for the two-Test series beginning in Galle next Saturday. But Pant isn't most people, and that's precisely what makes him the compelling attraction in front of the stumps that he has been since his Test debut in August 2018.

Pant fell just two balls after attempting a similar stroke that fell just beyond the reach of the backtracking mid-off fielder, compelling Mendis and skipper Sonal Dinusha to push Nishan Madushka back. Perhaps in a show of bravado, or more likely because he backed himself to middle the ball turning away from him and comfortably clear the fielder, Pant went through with the stroke only to put the ball up in the air for Madushka to complete a smart grab. Two runs from

five deliveries isn't what Pant, or the leadership group of Gill and Gambhir would have hoped for, but as mentioned earlier, India have been willing to accept the trade-off because when Pant gets going, the destruction he can wreak is beyond parallel.

Pant's dalliance with the vice-captaincy didn't last too long, the decision-makers arriving at the conclusion that he and Indian cricket would be better off without additional responsibilities being thrust on his shoulders. In his first sojourn as Gill's deputy, Pant was a runaway success. His batting in England, on admittedly excellent tracks for batting, was a sight for sore eyes. While Gill was wooing and wowing the connoisseurs with his correctness and his silken stroke-making on his way to 754 extraordinary runs, Pant was at his innovative, unpredictable best without compromising on consistency. In Leeds during the first Test, he became the first Indian stumper to notch up twin hundreds in England, backed it up with 25 and 65 in the series-levelling win in Birmingham, produced efforts of 74 and 9 in the Lord's loss and won himself a few million more fans by coming out to bat with a broken foot in the first innings and making a stirring 54 in the fourth Test in Manchester.

On-field heroism

The manner in which he contracted that injury, and the events that followed as he took on-field heroism to a different level, are archetypal Pant. The 28-year-old attempted a reverse against seamer Chris Woakes and only managed to play the ball on to his foot, carried off the field as that part of his body swelled up dramatically within seconds of the impact. When he came out to bat, hobbling and unable to put any weight on his right foot, he still found enough timing and power to smack fours - and a six - as he brought up his fifty to raucous applause and walked off to warm appreciation and genuine respect from England's fielders.

That broken foot not only ended his England tour but also kept him out of the home series against West Indies in October. By this time, Pant was clearly only in the running for Test matches. His last ODI was in August 2024, his last T20I a week before that, both in Sri Lanka in Gambhir's first assignment as Dravid's successor. Sanju Samson and Ishan Kishan in the shorter white-ball format, and K.L. Rahul and Kishan in the 50-over version, have surged well clear in the wicketkeeper-batter stakes, which means the only canvas available to Pant, apart from the IPL which hasn't been his happiest hunting ground, is the five-day spectacle.

Pant's return to Test cricket, against

South Africa in Kolkata in November, was anything but auspicious as India failed to hunt down 124 on an Eden minefield. Gill's batting efforts in that Test were restricted to just three deliveries in the first innings as he retired hurt with a neck injury, an affliction that kept him out of the second Test in Guwahati and thrust Pant into the Test skipper's role for the first time.

Hard times

It was a disastrous initiation; Pant himself played one of the most horrendous strokes of his career, a little after lunch on day three, then oversaw a 408-run hammering - India's heaviest by runs in Test history. A few months later came a campaign of gigantic failure in the IPL when, under Pant, Lucknow Supergiants hurtled from one misadventure to another. Even before the tournament had ended, Pant had stepped down as captain, and a few weeks later, it was confirmed that the IPL's most expensive player would return to his original franchise, Delhi Capitals, after taking a heavy pay cut.

Pant had a reasonably fruitful outing in the one-off Test against Afghanistan in New Chandigarh in June, with a somewhat restrained 81 in his, and India's, only innings of the game that they bossed all the way through. By then, though, he had been replaced as vice-captain by K.L. Rahul, one of the few individuals to have captained the country in all three formats, all in a stand-in capacity. It was the clearest indication that Agarkar's panel, if no one else, believed that Pant himself and the team as a whole would be better off if he was divested of official leadership responsibilities, though given his standing in the international circuit, Pant can't not be a leader in his own right.

Now, Pant can focus on his primary disciplines without having to attend lengthy team discussions or the distraction of being pulled in different directions, an inevitable fallout of additional role thrusts. Behind the stumps, he is unconventional and unorthodox, more Mahendra Singh Dhoni than Syed Kirmani or Nayan Mongia. In front of it, he is evidently in a league of his own. Like he showed on Sunday in Colombo, he can stonewall if so required - though even he will admit that he took it too far - and switch gears around his stonewalling without warning. It is exactly this unpredictability that makes him such an irascible force, a revolving door that can exasperate as much as it can exhilarate.

Impressive numbers

Despite the presence in the squad, and possibly in the playing XI, of Dhruv Jurel,

there is not even an artificial threat to Pant's presence in the Test scheme of things. After all, we are talking about someone who averages 43.37 from an even 50 Tests, at a jaw-dropping strike-rate of 74.05 embellished by eight centuries and 19 fifties in 87 innings. These are numbers that would do several specialist batters proud - remember that Mike Atherton and the recently retired Ajinkya Rahane both averaged less than 40 - and yet, there is more to Pant. Such as 162 catches and 16 stumpings, and the very rare ability to change the course of even Test matches with two hours of unadulterated mayhem.

Six of Pant's eight centuries have come away from home - four in England, and one each in Australia and South Africa - though like most of the rest of his colleagues, he hasn't played a Test match in Sri Lanka yet. In some ways, the conditions there will be strikingly similar to India, but in others, they won't be, especially when it comes to pace off the surface. Galle from Saturday, and the SSC ground the week thereafter, will ask questions of Pant that he hasn't been asked too often in the past, but knowing him, he will find the answers. How he uses those answers, however, will make for fun viewing, as much as how much and how freely he is allowed to use them. There is no point asking Pant to bat like Ravindra Jadeja because, well, he wouldn't be Pant then, would he? India need the most potent version of Pant to come to the fore. Only a really brave or stupid individual will bet against that eventuating.



THE GIST

Pant's rise as the vice-captain of the Test side was welcomed with as much breathless anticipation as Gill's to the captaincy. Or his arrival at the batting crease, if you like. With the chunky left-hander, you still don't know what to expect

In his first sojourn as Gill's deputy, Pant was a runaway success. His batting in England, on admittedly excellent tracks for batting, was a sight for sore eyes

The Tests in Galle and the SSC ground will ask questions of Pant that he hasn't been asked too often in the past, but knowing him, he will find the answers

If DNA is the instruction manual, we just opened a big second volume

A new study found that several inherited traits occur not because genes mutate but because of chemical modifications of the genome that can jump across generations, change depending on whether an animal is male or female, and even copy themselves from one copy of a gene to another

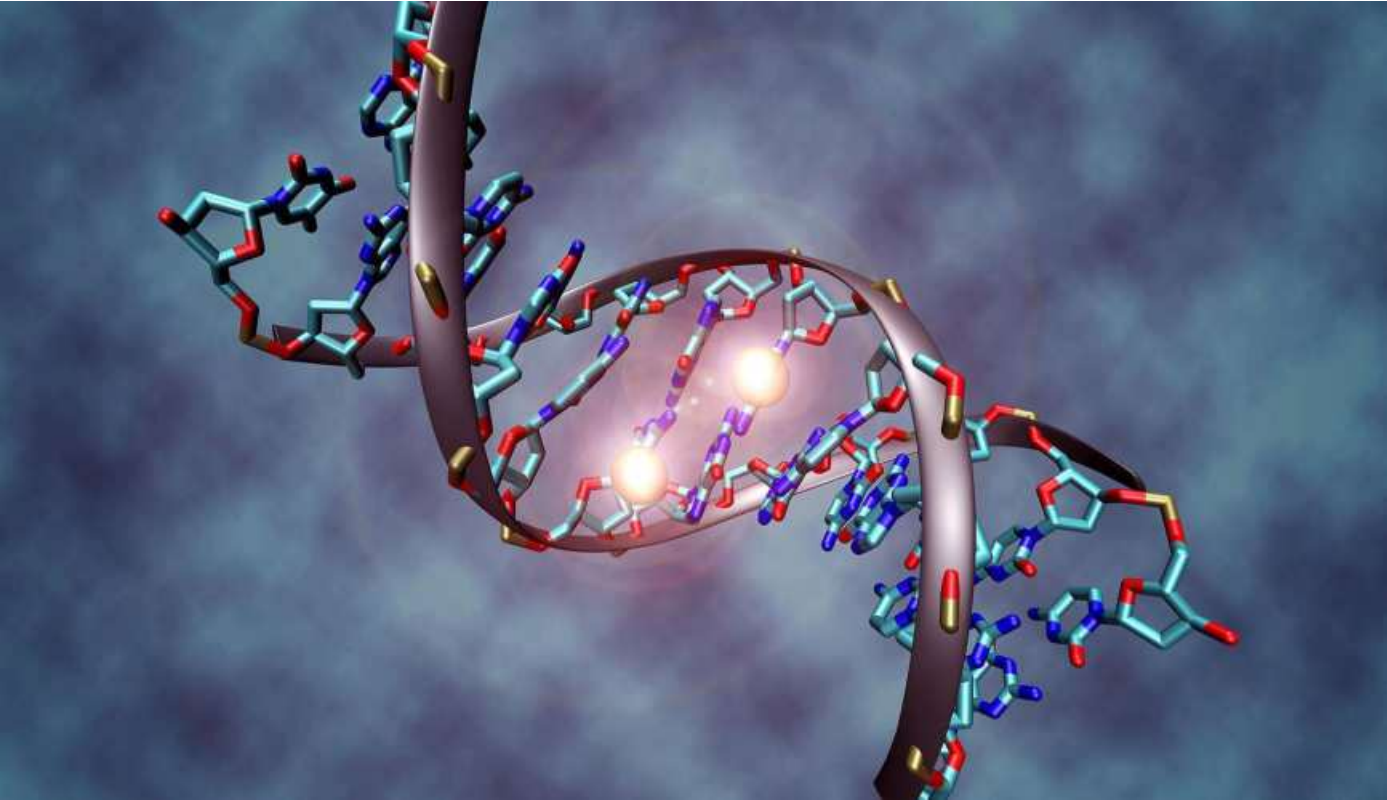
D.P. Kasbekar

A team led by researchers at the Johns Hopkins School of Medicine has found that several inherited traits in the mouse genome break the rules Gregor Mendel laid down in the 19th century about how genes work. This is not because the genes mutate but because of chemical modifications of the genome that can jump across generations, change depending on whether an animal is male or female, and even copy themselves from one copy of a gene to another. Their findings were reported recently in *Nature Genetics*. While the study was in mice, the implications go far beyond – as the same mechanisms may also shape human health, and be able to explain conditions that have long resisted genetic analysis.

‘On’ and ‘off’ genes
Every cell in the body carries two kinds of genetic information. One is the sequence – the order of the four chemical bases, A, T, G, and C, that spells out which proteins a gene produces. This is the genome that geneticists have spent decades mapping. The other is about whether a small chemical compound – called the methyl group (-CH₃) – is attached to the DNA at specific locations.

When cytosines are methylated, the gene is usually silenced. When the group is removed, the gene can be expressed again. This process of switching genes ‘on’ and ‘off’ without changing the underlying sequence is called epigenetic modification. Epigenetic modifications are not permanent. They can even differ between tissues – e.g. liver cells and muscle cells methylate differently. Many of them are also reversed when the body makes fresh sperm or eggs. The new study has found this rule to be violated.

Vastly underestimated
The researchers used a technology called nanopore sequencing. A single strand of DNA is threaded through a microscopic hole – the pore. As each base passes through, it produces a distinct blip in the electrical current flowing across the pore. Methylated cytosines produce a different blip from unmethylated ones. The team sequenced DNA from the liver and muscle tissues of mice belonging to two inbred strains. Their genomes differed at millions of positions. Of the 7,600 or so locations on the genomes where the methylation patterns differed, around 93% followed Mendel’s rules. That is, methylation had passed reliably from parent to offspring. But in the remaining 7% or so, the researchers identified more than 500 instances of



Representation of a DNA molecule that is methylated. The two white spheres represent methyl groups. They are bound to two cytosine nucleotide molecules that make up the DNA sequence. CHRISTOPH BOCK (CC BY-SA)

non-Mendelian epigenetic inheritance. To illustrate, in 305 genome regions, all in the liver, the methylation depended on whether the mouse was male or female. Mendel’s rules don’t allow this. In 304 of these regions, females’ genomes were more methylated than males’ genomes. While sex-specific methylation in the liver has been reported before in both mice and humans, the new study found that the scale has been vastly underestimated.

A new first
The researchers also identified at least five new genes displaying genomic imprinting – where the level of methylation depends on whether the gene was inherited from the mother or the father. The most striking finding had to do with a phenomenon called paramutation. Here, the methylation status of one copy of a gene – say, the one inherited from the father – is also transferred to the other copy, inherited from the mother. The ‘rewritten’ mother’s copy then persists through the next generation. Again, scientists had observed paramutation in plants and engineered mice before. This is the first time it has been reported to be naturally occurring in a mammal’s genome. In the study, the paramutated gene was *Capn11*, which contains the recipe for a protein that is active in the testes during meiosis. When this protein is not available

The researchers also identified at least five new genes displaying genomic imprinting – where the level of methylation depends on whether the gene was inherited from the mother or the father

in sufficient amounts, the effects may include infertility and azoospermia (having no sperm in the semen). The team also identified two likely instances of paramutation related to the gene *Vps37c* and a downstream stretch of the genome. Both these areas are associated with intracisternal A particles – the genetic remains of ancient viruses that became embedded in the mouse genome. According to the study’s authors, these particles may be central to the paramutation process since they have been known to resist the body’s mechanisms to remove epigenetic modifications when producing sperm or eggs. **Genome-wide association studies** The study also offers a new framework to explain heritable traits that researchers have struggled to study using genetics. For instance, a condition called hypertrichosis pinnae auris leads to the growth of coarse, dark hair on the outer ear and is prevalent among South Asian men. It is transmitted from fathers to sons

but never to daughters. According to the study’s results, if a father carries a paramutagenic version of the gene that causes this condition and the mother carries a ‘normal’ version, then in a son the paramutagenic copy would rewrite the maternal copy, leaving the son to have hairy ears. He could then pass the paramutagenic variant of the gene to his own children. But if the paramutagenic variant is demethylated in females – as the new findings suggest can happen – a daughter’s own copies of the gene would be unmethylated and her ears would be unaffected. Even more broadly, the findings imply that genome-wide association studies – an increasingly popular kind of study that looks for the genetic variants linked to diseases – may be missing a significant fraction of heritable variation because that variation is not in the sequence. Instead, the study’s authors have argued the work opens the door to a new kind of analysis: allele-specific epigenome-wide association studies, which trace methylation patterns rather than sequence variants, to find parts of the genome associated with diseases that conventional methods miss. Human genetics has long assumed that if you sequence the genome, you have read the instruction manual. It may be that the manual has a second volume – and we have barely opened it today. (D.P. Kasbekar is a retired scientist. kasbekardp@yahoo.co.in)

THE GIST

A team led by researchers at the Johns Hopkins School of Medicine has found that several inherited traits in the mouse genome break the rules Gregor Mendel laid down in the 19th century about how genes work

The study offers a new framework to explain heritable traits that researchers have struggled to study using genetics

The study’s authors have argued that the work opens the door to a new kind of analysis: allele-specific epigenome-wide association studies

BIG SHOT



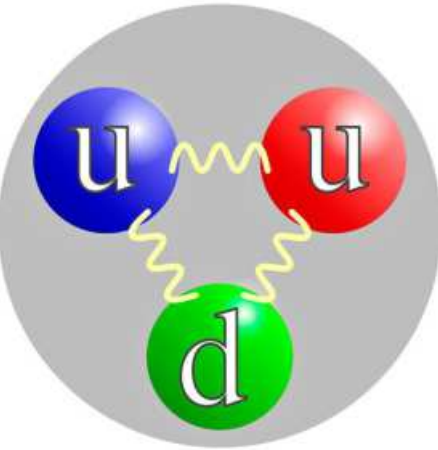
Workers prepare geo bags to prevent erosion of the Brahmaputra river bank at Borakhat village, in Kamrup district of Assam on August 7. ANI

WHAT IS IT?

Glueball: matter of force

Vasudevan Mukunth

Nature has four fundamental forces: gravity, the weak force (responsible for radioactivity), electromagnetism, and the strong force. The strong force is responsible for keeping the protons and neutrons together in the nuclei of atoms. The theory describing the strong interaction between two particles is called quantum chromodynamics (QCD). In QCD, the strong force is carried by gluons – just like how the electromagnetic force is carried by photons. But unlike photons, gluons carry a kind of charge that allows gluons to be attracted to each other. And QCD says they can come together to form composite particles called glueballs. In new research, scientists have taken a big step closer to showing glueballs exist. The team used data from the BESIII experiment in Beijing to uncover them. This is easier said than done because when a glueball appears in a particle physics experiment, it will be very short-lived and quickly decay into lighter particles in a way that is hard to distinguish from some other particles. Scientists had first observed a candidate glueball called X(2370) in BESIII data in 2011. Its mass seemed consistent with a glueball. They also estimated some of its properties based on the decays of a particle called the J/ψ meson. The new data buttresses the odds that



Protons are made up of three smaller particles called quarks, held together by the strong interaction mediated by particles called gluons. ARPAD HORVATH (CC BY-SA)

X(2370) is indeed a glueball by revealing more properties glueballs possess. Thus, BESIII has assembled the strongest case to date that X(2370) has a dominant glueball component, potentially providing the first evidence for a form of matter made just from the carriers of a fundamental force.

For feedback and suggestions for ‘Science’, please write to science@thehindu.co.in with the subject ‘Daily page’

Text & Context

THE HINDU

NEWS IN NUMBERS

Number of flight cancellations due to Typhoon Dolphin

1,300 Typhoon Dolphin made landfall in densely populated eastern China on Sunday, meteorological authorities said, after the storm triggered more than 1,000 flight cancellations, evacuations and a top-level alert. AFP

Grievances resolved by Delhi Police received during public hearings

368 The Delhi Police has resolved 368 complaints and grievances received during public hearings held at police stations across the national capital on Saturday, as part of its Thana Divas-Jansunwai initiative. The initiative was launched in June. PTI

Area of safe haven carved out for lions in Gujarat

100 hectares. Stepping up efforts to mitigate human-wildlife conflicts, the Gujarat forest department is establishing a 100-hectare enclosure at the Ambardi Safari Park in Amreli district to house Asiatic lions that have attacked humans, an official said on Sunday. PTI

Subsidy to be provided by Himachal Pradesh govt. for cold storage

70 in per cent. The Himachal Pradesh government will provide a 70% subsidy for establishing 5-metric-tonne cold storages, freeze-dry units and refrigerated vans. The cost has been fixed at ₹15 lakh for a 5 MT cold storage unit, ₹10 lakh for a freeze-dry unit and ₹20 lakh for a refrigerated van. PTI

Estimated annual rise in Taiwan's defence spending for 2027

16 in per cent. Taiwan's cabinet will propose a 16% annual rise in defence spending for 2027 which will for the first time exceed T\$1 trillion (\$31 billion), the official Central News Agency reported on Sunday, as Taipei bolsters its military. REUTERS
COMPILED BY THE HINDU DATA TEAM

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The stakes in India's delimitation debate

What triggers delimitation? How will the 2027 Census affect seat allocation? Can the exercise be completed before 2029? Which States could gain or lose seats? What happens without a constitutional amendment? How will women's reservation be implemented? How can new boundaries affect electoral outcomes?

EXPLAINER

Varghese K. George

The story so far:

The BJP is keen to kick off a fresh delimitation of Lok Sabha constituencies. It is trying to garner a two-thirds majority in Parliament to pass a Constitutional amendment for this purpose. In April 2026, it had moved the amendment but could not pass it. The Centre has not revealed its exact proposals. The proposals that the Centre placed before Parliament in the previous Session were the following:

1) Increase the size of the Lok Sabha up to a maximum of 850 seats; 2) distribute these seats among the States based on the 2011 Census through a fresh, countrywide delimitation of constituencies; and 3) reserve one-third of the total seats for women.

According to the existing Constitutional provisions, a fresh delimitation is possible only after the data of the 2027 Census is published, and reservation for women can be rolled out only along with it.

What happens if there is no Constitutional amendment?

For a fresh delimitation to happen, a Constitutional amendment is not required. A fresh delimitation will be triggered soon after the data of the 2027 census is published. The terms for the next delimitation are already written into the Constitution, principally in Articles 81 and 82. A Constitutional amendment is required only if the existing constitutional provisions relating to delimitation are to be changed.

Articles 81 and 82 mandate that after the data from the first Census conducted after 2026 is published, two things will happen.

The first is a reallocation of the existing strength of the Lok Sabha among the States and Union Territories on the basis of the population recorded in that Census, which would, in this case, be the 2027 Census. The second is the delimitation of individual constituencies within each State.

Therefore, if there is no Constitutional amendment at all, there will be a delimitation exercise that must begin after the data of the 2027 Census is published.

ratio remains as of today.

The 2027 Census is the first time that data gathering has been completely digitalised. Theoretically, it is possible that the delimitation process could be quicker than before. If the exercise is not completed before the 2029 Lok Sabha elections, it could continue into the term of the next Lok Sabha and the government.

The last Delimitation Commission was appointed during A. B. Vajpayee's tenure as the Prime Minister, and its work was completed during the first term of the Manmohan Singh government, with a Lok Sabha election in 2004 in between. The same can happen with the next Delimitation Commission.

What will be the mandate of the next Delimitation Commission?

If a fresh delimitation is triggered under the existing provisions of Articles 81 and 82, the following will happen.

At present, the distribution of the 543 Lok Sabha seats among the States is based on the population figures of the 1971 Census. When the benchmark changes from the 1971 population to the population recorded in the first Census after 2026, the seat distribution is likely to change (**Table 1**). Broadly speaking, the southern States are likely to face a reduction in their share of Lok Sabha seats, while the Hindi-speaking States, particularly Uttar Pradesh, Bihar and Rajasthan, are likely to gain seats. The maximum number of Lok Sabha seats allowed by the Constitution is 550. A third of the Lok Sabha seats nationally, and one-third of the seats within each State, will be reserved for women.

So, in the absence of any Constitutional amendment, the following sequence is envisaged: first, the reallocation of Lok Sabha seats among States; second, the delimitation of constituencies within States; and third, the implementation of women's reservation – all tied to the Census 2027.

How is the allocation of seats to each State determined?

Think of India as one large joint family and the States as its constituent family units. Imagine that each individual across the joint family was entitled to one acre of land (**Image 1**). A family with five members got five acres, another with seven members got seven acres, and so on. Each family then divided its share among its members. At that point, everyone got roughly the same share. In political terms, every vote had roughly the same value. But then time passed. Some families grew much faster than others. In the larger families, the same land had to be shared among more people. In the smaller families, fewer people shared the same land. As a result, the value of each person's share began to differ.

That is, in a sense, what has happened to votes in India. In 1967, an MP across most major States represented roughly four to five lakh electors. Today, a MP from Kerala represents about 14 lakh electors, while in Uttar Pradesh and Bihar, the figure is around 19 lakh.

This variation is the result of a deliberate decision by all parties, taken on two occasions, in 1976 and 2001, not to punish States that had stabilised their populations. The Constitution gives that leeway. The size of Lok Sabha constituencies is not necessarily based on a national average, which today would be about 18 lakh voters per constituency. Article 81 requires seats to be allocated among States "so far as practicable", on the basis of a national average. This leeway for variation allows for a balance between two principles that can be in tension: federalism, or representation of States, and democracy, or one vote, one value.

And that is the central tension the debate

Image 1

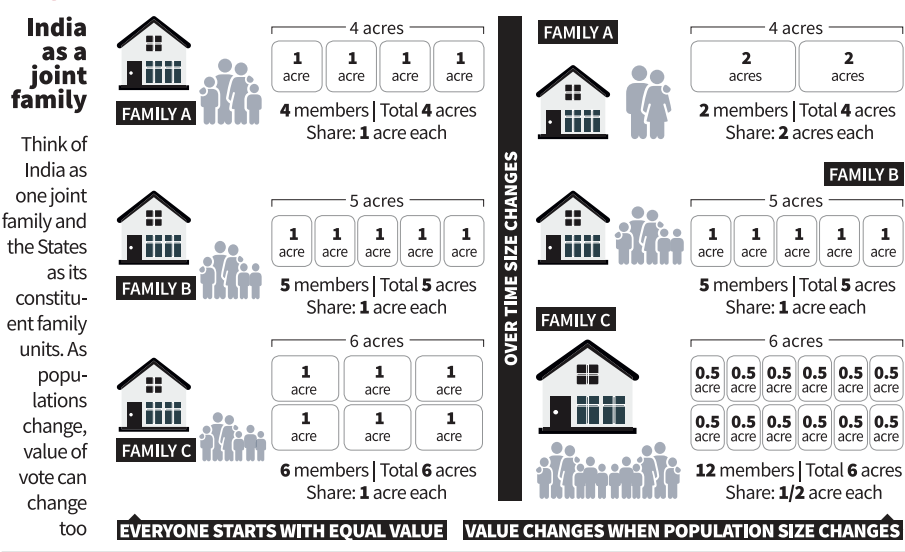
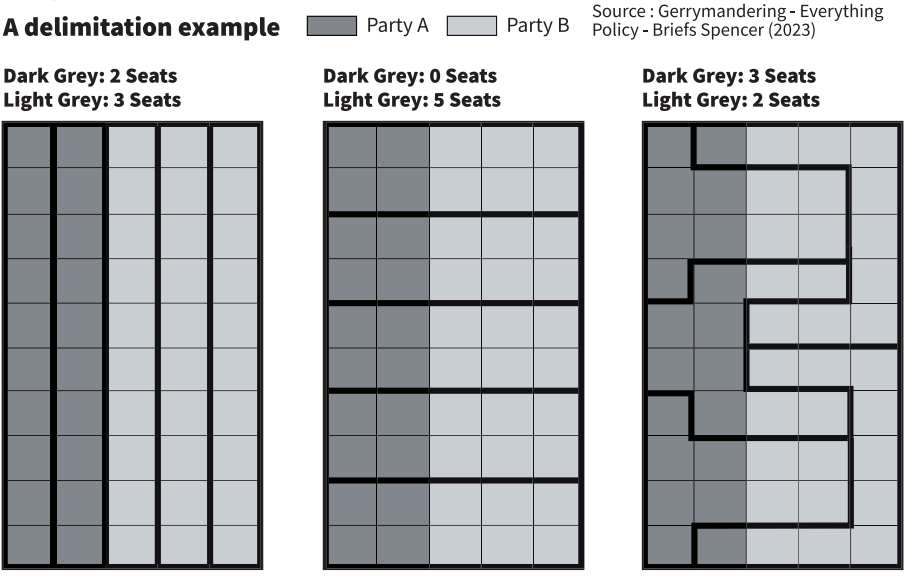


Image 2



Comparison of Lok Sabha seat distribution based on 2024 electors and 2011 population							
State/ Union Territory	Current Seats (543)	Seats*	Seats**	State/ Union Territory	Current Seats (543)	Seats*	Seats**
A.P.	25	23	22	Tamil Nadu	39	35	32
Arunachal Pradesh	2	0	1	Tripura	2	2	2
Assam	14	14	14	U.P.	80	86	90
Bihar	40	43	47	WB	42	42	41
Goa	2	1	1	Chhattisgarh	11	11	11
Gujarat	26	27	27	Jharkhand	14	14	15
Haryana	10	11	11	Uttarakhand	5	5	5
H.P.	4	3	3	Telangana	17	18	16
Karnataka	28	30	27	Andaman & Nicobar Islands	1	0	0
Kerala	20	15	15	Chandigarh	1	0	0
M.P.	29	31	33	Dadra & NH and Daman & Diu	2	0	0
Maharashtra	48	52	50	Delhi	7	8	8
Manipur	2	1	1	Lakshadweep	1	0	0
Meghalaya	2	1	1	Puducherry	1	1	1
Mizoram	1	0	0	J&K	5	5	6
Nagaland	1	1	1	Ladakh	1	0	0
Odisha	21	19	19	Total	543	541	543
Punjab	13	12	12				
Rajasthan	25	30	31				
Sikkim	1	0	0				

on delimitation now needs to resolve.

What is gerrymandering?

When we discuss the democratic principle of One Person, One Vote, One Value, the first requirement is that every Lok Sabha constituency should have roughly the same number of voters. But equal numbers alone do not guarantee equal value for every vote. Why? Because even when constituencies contain the same number of voters, the way those voters are grouped can dramatically affect electoral outcomes.

Consider a simple example (**Image 2**). Imagine there are 50 voters. Party A has 20 supporters and Party B has 30 supporters. There are five constituencies, each with 10 voters and electing one representative.

In the first scenario, voters are distributed fairly across the five constituencies. The result broadly reflects the overall vote share. Party A and Party B win seats broadly in proportion to their

support. In the second scenario, Party A's voters are spread thinly across constituencies. This is called cracking. Although Party A has 40% of all voters, it may not have enough support to win even one constituency. Thus, 40% of voters could end up with no representation at all.

In the third scenario, Party B's voters are heavily concentrated in a few constituencies. This is known as packing. Party B wins those seats with huge margins but ends up wasting votes, allowing Party A to win more seats despite having fewer supporters overall.

The way constituency boundaries are drawn can profoundly shape democratic representation and electoral outcomes.

Extracted from the author's introduction to 'The Delimitation Debate: The Union and its Units,' published by The Hindu. Order the book here:



THE GIST

The 2027 Census is set to trigger a fresh delimitation of Lok Sabha constituencies under Articles 81 and 82, even without a new Constitutional amendment.

The exercise could significantly alter the distribution of Lok Sabha seats, with southern States likely to lose their share and Uttar Pradesh, Bihar and Rajasthan likely to gain.

Redrawing constituency boundaries could also affect electoral outcomes, as the grouping of voters through 'cracking' and 'packing' can influence which parties win seats.



Gearing up: A fresh delimitation will be triggered soon after the data of the 2027 census is published. SUSHIL KUMAR VERMA

Can a fresh delimitation be completed before the 2029 Lok Sabha elections?

May or may not. In the past, delimitation exercises took several years. The last one was set up on 12 July 2002, after the 2001 Census. Its recommendations were implemented in 2008, and the 2009 Lok Sabha elections were held based on newly drawn constituencies.

The last delimitation did not involve a reallocation of seats of individual States; only the existing constituencies within each State were redrawn. The last time Lok Sabha seats were reallocated among States was in 1973, based on the 1971 Census. That

